

Parasitic Participles in Faroese as Auxiliary Omission*

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Abstract

The relationship between auxiliaries and verbal inflection has been a debated issue in syntactic theory since Chomsky (1957) and contemporary theories disagree on whether to analyze the facts through a combination of syntactic selection and merger or head displacement (Halle and Marantz 1993, Lasnik 1995, Harwood 2014) or in terms of inflection-as-agreement (Adger 2003, Bjorkman 2011, Wurmbrand 2012). An important argument for inflection-as-agreement comes from parasitic morphology in the Germanic languages. This paper presents a novel case of parasitic morphology in which the auxiliary *have* itself can take vacuous inflection as predicted by inflection-as-agreement accounts. This kind of account also allows us to explain why Faroese parasitic morphology initially appears to be non-vacuous. Once we recognize that *have* shows parasitic agreement and adopt the idea that participle morphology on the perfect auxiliary can trigger deletion of the auxiliary, the Faroese facts straightforwardly follow from syntactic agreement.

1 Introduction

A well-known problem in the study of auxiliaries is that certain auxiliary verbs systematically co-occur with specific inflectional forms of verbs. For instance, English modals (1a) combine with the default infinitive verb form, but the English perfect auxiliary *have* specifically requires a verb in the past participle form (1b).

- (1) a. Mary *may / can / will / should* **talk** to Linda.
b. John *has* **talked** to Rose.

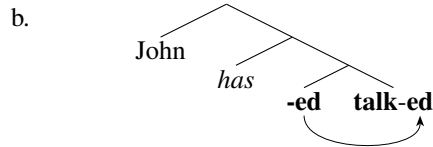
This pattern is surprising as the past participle form of the verb does not necessarily seem to convey the meaning of the perfect. Many other languages convey the same meaning more transparently with a single morpheme and no specific verb form (see overview in Anderson 2006). For instance, in the Austroasiatic language Temiar, the perfect is formed with the default form of the verb and an invariant perfect particle *hɔj* (2).

- (2) a. na-cīb.
3SG-go
'He goes.'
b. **hɔj** na-cīb.
PERF 3SG-go
'He has gone.'

(Temiar; Anderson 2006: 118)

In a classic analysis, Chomsky (1957) argues that the correlation between auxiliaries and the inflectional form of the verb is rooted in syntax. He proposes that a verbal inflectional affix, such as the participial suffix, is generated with the auxiliary and that there is a rule of affix hopping which attaches the affix to the verb. As a result, we correctly predict, for instance, that the perfect auxiliary *have* should systematically co-occur with a participial affix in a language like English, as illustrated in (3).

- (3) a. John *has* **talked** to Rose.



However, a major problem for contemporary syntactic theory is how exactly the insight of this dependency should be translated to a minimalist model which assumes as few primitive operations as possible.

An influential approach describes this kind of morphosyntactic selection in terms of *inflection-as-agreement* (Adger 2003, Wiklund 2007, Bjorkman 2011, Wurmbrand 2012, 2014a). This approach relates the English case to patterns in other languages where one item is dependent on another and both must express the same

*Special thanks to Katarina Jákupsdóttir, Gunnhild Hansen, Iben Nyholm Debess, Sandra Saxov, Hjalmar P. Petersen, Zakaris Svabo Hansen, Uni Johannesen and Annika Simonsen for judgments and comments on the Faroese data, to Filippa Lindahl, Elisabet Engdahl for Swedish judgments and to Øystein Alexander Vangsnes and Dag-Tore Nordbø Kristiansen for Norwegian judgments. Many thanks to Coppe van Urk, Hagit Borer, Jim Wood, David Pesetsky and Elise Newman for discussion, and to audiences at CGSW36 and PLC48.

features. For instance, in French gender concord, adjectives show the same inflection as the nouns that they modify. The French adjective *bon* ‘good’ takes a different form when it modifies a masculine noun (4a) than when it modifies a feminine noun (4b). The same inflection can further spread across multiple adjectives (5).¹

- (4) a. un bon étudiant.
a.MASC good.MASC student.MASC
‘A good student.’
b. une bonn-e id-ée.
a.FEM good-FEM idea-FEM
‘A good idea.’
- (5) cett-e tout-e petit-e pièce
this-FEM all-FEM small-FEM room
‘This very small room.’
(French; cf. Rowlett 2007: 51–98)

Although it might not be obvious, the verbal form dependency in English (1b) can be analyzed as a similar kind of agreement as in French since the participle also expresses the same information as the auxiliary *have*.

An important observation supporting the inflection-as-agreement approach is the fact that the feature on *have* and the participle can spread multiple times with no sense of extra meaning. In several Germanic languages, a complement clause that would ordinarily be infinitival can show participle morphology if preceded by a participle. These so-called *Parasitic Participles* are found, for example, in certain American English dialects ((6); participles are **bolded**).

- (6) ... opening my eyes to things I wouldn’t have **dared eaten** before. (Wood 2022: 4)

While *have* and a past participle usually convey the semantics of the perfect, Parasitic Participles do not have a semantic effect. Parasitic morphology thus provides an important argument for the idea that morphosyntactic selection between verbs reflects syntactic agreement, as argued by den Dikken and Hoekstra (1997), Wiklund (2007) and Wurmbrand (2012).² An agreement analysis coupled with the observation that participial morphology typically only spreads to multiple verbs with restructuring predicates provides a natural explanation of Parasitic Participles (Wiklund 2007, Wurmbrand 2012). In Wurmbrand’s (2012) analysis verbs agree upward with the closest valued feature that c-commands them. Wurmbrand argues that restructuring complements may lack the feature responsible for licensing infinitives so that the embedded verb instead agrees with the same feature as the restructuring verb. In the perfect, we thus predict that both verbs should agree with a participial feature which in turn derives Parasitic Participles.

In this paper, I provide a novel argument for a syntactic agreement account of morphosyntactic selection based on a comparison of Parasitic Participles in Faroese, Norwegian and Swedish. Norwegian and Swedish Parasitic Participles, similar to the American English example in (6), only appear in the complements of restructuring verbs like modals. In accordance with the idea that Parasitic Participles are semantically vacuous, they are only associated with a simultaneous interpretation in these languages. In (7), the context requires an experiential reading, but a Parasitic Participle is infelicitous as it cannot supply the appropriate reading.

Context: The speaker is talking about their grandmother who died when the speaker was young. The speaker expresses regret over never having met their grandmother.

- (7) a. #Jeg har alltid **villet** **møtt** / møta mormoren min.
I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP met.PTCP / meet.INF grandmother my
‘I have always wanted to meet my grandmother.’ (implies grandmother is alive) (Norwegian)
b. #Jag har alltid **velat** **träffat** / träffa min mormor.
I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP met.PTCP / meet.INF my grandmother
‘I have always wanted to see my grandmother.’ (implies grandmother is alive) (Swedish)

¹Glossing abbreviations: PERF = Perfect, 1/2/3 = 1st/2nd/3rd person, SG = singular, MASC = masculine gender, FEM = feminine gender, PRS = present tense, PST = past tense, PTCP = participle, INF = infinitive, PASS = passive voice, DAT = dative, REFL = reflexive

²In an early Minimalist account, den Dikken and Hoekstra (1997) use spec-head feature checking/agreement instead of Agree which is particularly suited to Frisian since the agreement correlates with word order differences.

However, Faroese presents an apparent problem for the inflection-as-agreement approach to parasitic morphology. Surprisingly, Parasitic Participles in Faroese do have an obligatorily perfect reading. This is clear from the comparison between the non-perfect Norwegian and Swedish examples in (7), and the corresponding Faroese example in (8) which has a perfect interpretation. For Faroese, only the participle *møtt* ‘meet’, either bare or with *have*, supplies the appropriate reading. The infinitive form *møta*, on the other hand, is infelicitous.

Context: The speaker is talking about their grandmother who died when the speaker was young. The speaker expresses regret over never having met their grandmother.

- (8) Eg havi altíð viljað møtt / #møta ommu mínari.
 I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP meet.PTCP / meet.INF grandmother.DAT my.DAT
 ‘I have always wanted to have met my grandmother’ (Faroese)
Consultant comment: ‘møta does not work, needs to be møtt because the grandmother has died.’

Another unexpected property of Faroese Parasitic Participles from the perspective of Wiklund (2007) and Wurmbrand (2012) is that they can occur in non-restructuring complements with verbs like *expect* (9).

- (9) Hann hevði væntað, at {koma / komið} heim í næstu viku.
 he had.PST expected.PTCP to come.INF / come.PTCP home in next week
 ‘He had expected to come home next week / to have come (by) next week.’ (Faroese)

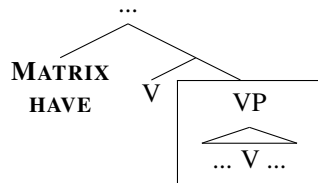
The contrast in (8) is especially surprising given other indications that Parasitic Participles reflect syntactic agreement with no semantic effect. The Faroese data thus raise the question: Should such facts be modeled as syntactic agreement (Wiklund 2007, Wurmbrand 2012) or should they be given a semantic explanation?³

In this paper, I show that, contrary to initial appearances, the Faroese construction and its semantic effect in fact provide novel evidence for the syntactic agreement approach to Parasitic Participles and to verbal morphology more generally. I point out that the oddity of Faroese arises because of the combination of two facts: overt *have* can be the target of participial agreement and participial *have* independently undergoes deletion. In fact, *have* must appear in its participle form (*havi*) in Parasitic Participle configurations (10), and not as an infinitive (*hava*) as in the Norwegian and Swedish constructions (cf. Thráinsson et al. 2012: 75–77).

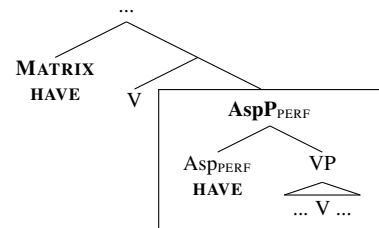
- (10) Hon hevði ynskt at (havi) verið á Woodstock.
 she had wished to have.PTCP been.PTCP at Woodstock
 ‘She had wanted to have gone to Woodstock.’ (Faroese)

Importantly, the participial agreement on perfect *have* is actually a prediction that comes out of the syntactic agreement approach. Assuming all verbs can parasitically agree with the same feature, we expect that parasitic morphology should in principle be capable of spreading to auxiliaries, as well as lexical verbs, provided that the locality conditions are appropriate, which I suggest is the case in Faroese examples such as (10). In accordance with Wurmbrand (2012), I argue that in Norwegian and Swedish, Parasitic Participles occur in a small complement clause that lacks tense and only contains a verb (11). The relevant Faroese complement clause, however, contains a perfect head which realizes the auxiliary *have* (12).⁴

- (11) Norwegian & Swedish structure



- (12) Faroese structure



³The concord-like Sequence of Tense effects (Abusch 1988 and many others) pose a similar problem.

⁴The trees gloss over *v*, Voice and projections that may contribute to the semantics of the perfect (Iatridou et al. 2003, Pancheva 2003).

The second key ingredient of this analysis is that the participial *have* is independently omissible. Participial *have* is also found following past tense modals where it can similarly undergo omission (13).

- (13) Hon kundi (havt) farið, um hon vildi.
 he could.PST have.PTCP go.PTCP where she wanted.PST
 ‘She could have gone where she wanted to.’ (Faroese; cf. Thráinsson et al. 2012: 75–77)

The example in (13) shows that *have* can be omitted in Faroese. Accordingly, I argue that the semantic effect in Faroese Parasitic Participles arises because the underlying structure is the one given in (12) with a silent *have*. The silent *have* leads us to expect the perfect reading in (8) in Faroese which would be mysterious if the second participle were truly vacuous. I argue that *have* goes unpronounced due to a post-syntactic deletion rule triggered by a marked feature combination (Nevins 2011; Arregi and Nevins 2012).⁵ I propose that when a *have*-licensing feature and a participle-licensing feature co-occur on the same head – something which only happens in Parasitic Participle configurations – they trigger deletion of the auxiliary.

This analysis explains the difference between Parasitic Participles in Faroese and in other languages while still maintaining the insight that verbal morphology is the result of syntactic agreement. In fact, Faroese provides new evidence for an agreement account because it shows that, as such an account predicts, auxiliaries can be the target of parasitic morphology and that it is not parasitic morphology itself that gives rise to a semantic effect in Faroese despite initial appearances. In this paper, I also discuss an independent argument for the analysis which comes from VP Fronting. While Parasitic Participles must usually spread without intervention, VP Fronting can exceptionally license non-local participial agreement across an infinitive in Norwegian and Swedish. However, this VP Fronting effect does not occur in Faroese. I show how this pattern follows from the idea that the source of participial morphology on the verb is different in Faroese.

The paper is organized as follows. Section 2 introduces Parasitic Participles and explains why they provide a key argument for the idea that selection of verbal morphology reflects syntactic agreement. Section 3 shows that unlike the Norwegian and Swedish constructions, Faroese Parasitic Participles have a semantic effect and a different distribution across complement clause types but still seem to have the locality of Agree. Section 4 proposes that Parasitic Participles in Faroese involve a larger complement clause licensed by a parasitic, and optionally silent, *have*. Section 5 shows how VP Fronting provides a new argument for the agreement analysis of parasitic morphology, if we assume an intermediate movement step, as well as an argument for two underlyingly different sources of Parasitic Participles, *have*-omission in Faroese and parasitic agreement in Norwegian and Swedish.

2 Parasitic Participles

In this section, I introduce Parasitic Participles in Germanic and show that they are naturally explained as syntactic agreement given that they are limited to restructuring clauses and since parasitic morphology can only spread locally and not across intervening infinitives. I also adopt the account in Wurmbrand (2012) where selection of verbal morphology is treated as syntactic agreement.

2.1 Parasitic Participles as Syntactic Agreement

In Germanic, the perfect is formed with the auxiliary *have* and a past participle and so the past participle is usually tied to the perfect. However, in several languages, a complement clause that would ordinarily be infinitival can show participle morphology if preceded by a participle, so-called *Parasitic Participles*. This includes Frisian (which has an OV-word order) (den Dikken and Hoekstra 1997), dialects of American English (Wood 2013, 2022), and three Scandinavian languages: Faroese, Norwegian and Swedish (14).⁶

⁵A more well-known case of auxiliary omission in Scandinavian is omission of finite *have* in Swedish (Julien 2002).

⁶Parasitic Participles also reportedly appear in Dutch (Zwart 2023) and German (Wurmbrand 2012). However, these constructions are licensed in a different manner (via movement only) and are much less productive than in the other languages discussed here. Danish and Icelandic do not generally allow Parasitic Participles (though see Sigurðsson 2012 for exceptional examples in Icelandic).

- (14) a. Hy soe it *dwaan* / **dien** **wollen** *ha*.
 he would it do.INF / do.PTCP want.PTCP have.INF
 ‘He would have liked to do it. (Frisian; den Dikken and Hoekstra 1997: 1058)
- b. I would have **rathered** *go* / **gone** to a small school. (American English; Wood 2022: 10)
- c. Han hade länge **velat** *komma* / **kommit** hem nästa vecka.
 he had.PST long wanted.PTCP come.INF / come.PTCP home next week
 ‘He had long wanted to come home next week.’ (Swedish; Wiklund 2007: 62)

The three main properties of Germanic Parasitic Participles are usually taken to be the lack of an interpretive effect of parasitic morphology, a distribution limited to restructuring clauses and syntactic locality effects.

The first property, semantically vacuous morphology, is seen in the examples in (14) where the second past participle is taken to be parasitic in the sense that it is dependent on a previous participle and does not clearly have the same perfect semantics (den Dikken and Hoekstra 1997; Wiklund 2007; Wood 2013). Instead, the participle is interpreted as an infinitive in American English, Swedish (and Norwegian) and Frisian, as indicated by the translation of the examples in (14) (and as argued by den Dikken and Hoekstra 1997: 1065, Wiklund 2007: 20, Jim Wood, p.c.).⁷

The second property, that Parasitic Participles are a restructuring phenomenon, relates to the complement types that parasitic morphology shows up in. Infinitival complements are commonly believed to vary in clause size. Much work presupposes, for example, that attitude verbs, like *believe*, and emotive verbs, like *decide*, take bigger complements than other verbs (Rizzi 1976, Wurmbrand 2001, Cinque 2006, Wurmbrand and Lohninger 2023). These verbs are often assumed to take a *tensed complement* since the temporal reference can be independent of the matrix tense. Wiklund (2007) and Wurmbrand (2012) show that Parasitic Participles appear exclusively with so-called *restructuring verbs* which take smaller complements with no independent time reference, that is, *tenseless complements*. I have confirmed this claim with native speakers of Norwegian and Swedish. As Wiklund (2007) shows, Swedish Parasitic Participles can occur with restructuring verbs like the modal *kunna* ‘can’, the aspectual *låta* ‘let/make’ and the implicative *hinna* ‘manage’ (15).⁸

(15) *Swedish Parasitic Participles in tenseless complements*

- a. Han hade **kunnat** {*läsa* / **läst**}.
 he had.PST can.PTCP {read.INF / read.PTCP}
 ‘He had been able to read.’
- b. Jag hade **låt**it det {*komma* / **kommit**} fem personer.
 I had.PST let.PTCP it come.INF / come.PTCP five people
 ‘I had let five people come.’
- c. Jag hade **hunnit** {*läsa* / **läst**} bok-en.
 I had.PST managed.PTCP read.INF / read.PTCP book-the.
 ‘I had managed to read the book.’ (Swedish; Wiklund 2007: 53–54,78)

However, Parasitic Participles never occur in the tensed complements of verbs like *expect* or *promise* (16).⁹

(16) *No Swedish Parasitic Participles in tensed complements*

- a. Han hade **förväntat-s** {*komma* / ***kommit**} hem nästa vecka.
 he had.PST expected.PTCP-REFL come.INF / come.PTCP home next week
 ‘He had been expected to come home next week.’ (Wiklund 2007: 47)
- b. Han hade **lovat** o {*komma* / ***kommit**} hem nästa vecka.
 he had.PST promised.PTCP to come.INF / come.PTCP home next week
 ‘He had promised to come home next week’ (Swedish)

⁷The past participle is formally identical to the neuter singular form of the passive participle in Faroese and Norwegian, but formally distinct in Swedish. As passive auxiliaries never license Parasitic Participles I set them aside.

⁸The same restructuring predicates are argued to occur in various languages including German, Dutch, Italian and Japanese (Wurmbrand 2001: 7).

⁹Swedish *förvänta* ‘expect’ in (16a) is reflexive and only selects an infinitive if passivized. However, this is immaterial to the point that I am making.

Parasitic Participles in Norwegian are also limited to restructuring complements like *kunna* ‘can’ (17). They cannot occur in tensed complements of verbs like *expect* or *promise* (18).

(17) *Norwegian Parasitic Participles in tenseless complements*

- a. Han hadde **kunnet** {*lese* / **lest**}.
he had.PST can.PTCP read.INF / read.PTCP
‘He had been able to read.’
- b. Jeg hadde **latt** det {*gå* / **gått**} for langt.
I had.PST let.PTCP it go.INF / go.PTCP too far
‘I had let it go too far.’
- c. Jeg hadde klart å {*lese* / **lest**} bok-en.
I had.PST managed.PTCP to read.INF / read.PTCP book-the
‘I had managed to read the book.’

(Norwegian)

(18) *No Norwegian Parasitic Participles in tensed complements*

- a. Jeg hadde **foreventet** å {*komma* / ***kommet**} hjem neste uke.
I had.PST expected.PTCP to come.INF / come.PTCP home next week
‘I had expected to come home next week.’
- b. Han hadde **lovet** å {*komma* / ***kommet**} hjem neste uke.
he had.PST promised.PTCP to come.INF / come.PTCP home next week
‘He had promised to come home next week.’

(Norwegian)

I thus conclude that Parasitic Participles in Norwegian and Swedish are a restructuring effect.

The third property of Parasitic Participles is that they are subject to intervention. In Norwegian and Swedish, Parasitic Participles must spread locally from the c-commanding participial feature to each agreeing verb, so an infinitive cannot occur in-between two participles (see Wiklund 2007). The crucial observation is that an infinitive may always be licensed in a non-finite clause, regardless of the morphology of the higher verb, but a Parasitic Participle is never licensed if it is c-commanded by an infinitive (19)–(20).

(19) *Norwegian Parasitic Participles must spread locally*

- a. Han har alltid **villet** **ønsket** {**pratet** / *prate*} italienskt.
he have.PRS always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP speak.PTCP / speak.INF Italian
- b. Han har alltid **villet** {**ønsket** / **ønske*} **pratet** italienskt.
he have.PRS always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP / can.INF speak.PTCP Italian
‘He has always wanted to be able to speak Italian.’

(Norwegian)

(20) *Swedish Parasitic Participles must spread locally*

- a. Han har alltid **velat** **kunnat** {**pratet** / *prata*} italienska.
he have.PRS always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP speak.PTCP / speak.INF Italian
- b. Han har alltid **velat** {**kunnat** / **kunna*} **pratet** italienska.
he have.PRS always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP / can.INF speak.PTCP Italian
‘He has always wanted to be able to speak Italian.’

(Swedish)

Importantly, infinitives only cause intervention effects with Parasitic Participles.¹⁰ Non-parasitic participles can follow infinitives, for example, when infinitival perfect *have* selects a participle (21).

- (21) Lars hade **börjat** o *ha* **läst** bok-en.
Lars had.PST begun.PTCP to have.INF read.PTCP book-the
‘Lars had begun to have finished reading the book.’

(Swedish; Wiklund 2007: 20)

Thus, infinitive intervention is specifically a feature of Parasitic Participles, not of all participles. Taken together, the three previously argued for properties of Parasitic Participles, that is, vacuous morphology, the

¹⁰Frisian Parasitic Participles are also degraded if an infinitive intervenes between participles (den Dikken and Hoekstra 1997: 1068). However, this restriction cannot be tested in American English as the construction only involves one Parasitic Participle (Jim Wood, p.c.).

restriction to restructuring context and the locality effects, all indicate syntactic agreement.

One other interesting property of Scandinavian is the possibility of intervening infinitival markers between Parasitic Participles (22). Faroese and Norwegian allow the normal infinitival marker in such configurations, while Swedish only allows the reduced form of the marker, *o*, not the full form *att*.¹¹

- (22) a. Honum hevði **dámt** *at* **fingið** mjólk *at* **drukkið**.
 he.DAT have.PST like.PTCP to get.PTCP milk to drink.PTCP
 ‘He would have liked to have got milk to drink.’ (Faroese; Henriksen 2000: 43)
- b. Da hadde **vore** fint *å* **hatt** noken *tè* *å* **hjelp** seg.
 it have.PST been.PTCP good to have.PTCP someone for to help.PTCP REFL
 ‘It would have been good to have someone to help you.’ (Norwegian)
- c. Jag hade **hållit** på *o* **skrivit** henne i två dar.
 I had.PST kept.PTCP on to written.PTCP her in two days.
 ‘I had kept writing to her for two days.’ (Swedish; Wiklund 2007: 50)

The infinitival markers are another indication that the intervention effect on Parasitic Participles necessarily involves c-command rather than, for instance, adjacency. Since these markers do not seem interfere with Parasitic Participles I set them aside.

2.2 Syntactic agreement analyses of Parasitic Participles

As we have seen, Parasitic Participles display several hallmarks of syntactic agreement such as semantically vacuous morphology and sensitivity to locality restrictions. This section adopts an influential approach to Parasitic Participles which treats them as *Syntactic Agreement* (Wiklund 2007, Wurmbrand 2012, Wood 2013) where an agreement relationship is formed between the perfect auxiliary and the verbs that it c-commands.

I follow Wurmbrand’s (2012) analysis of Parasitic Participles where the morphological selection of an auxiliary is achieved via Agree. This analysis accounts for the connection to restructuring, the vacuous interpretation and the infinitive intervention. Wurmbrand assumes that inflectional morphology is passed down to verbs via an Agree relation between an uninterpretable feature (*u*INFL) on the verb and an interpretable feature (*i*INFL) on a functional head c-commanding the verb (23a). Note that Wurmbrand (2012) uses the abbreviations [*u*F] and [*i*F] which I annotate as [*i*INFL] and [*u*INFL] to indicate their special status as *verbal inflectional features*,

¹¹I do not assume that Scandinavian infinitival markers indicate tense as sometimes suggested for English *to* (Stowell 1982 et seq.). Unlike English, Scandinavian modals and infinitival markers freely co-occur so they cannot be assumed to compete for one position (i).

- (i) a. tað átti **at kunna**[ð] verið gjørt rímuliga skjótt
 this ought.PST to can.PTCP been.PTCP done.PTCP reasonably quick
 ‘This ought to have been done reasonably quickly.’ (Faroese; Sosialurin.fo)
- b. Alt maset om **å skulle** være så innmari spesiell.
 all talk.the about to should.PST be.INF so exceedingly special
 ‘All this talk about how incredibly special you should be.’ (Norwegian; NRK.no)
- c. ?Han höll på **o skulle** läsa.
 he hold.PST on to should.PST read.INF
 ‘He was about to read.’ (Swedish; Wiklund 2007: 81)

Further, the infinitival markers occupy different clausal positions in these languages. In Swedish, the marker precedes VP adverbials and negation, in Faroese, the marker follows them, while in Norwegian, it can appear in either position (ii).

- (ii) a. Hon hevur lovað, {***at**} **ikki** {**at**} gera tað aftur.
 she has.PRS promised.PTCP {***to**} not {**to**} do.INF it again
 ‘She has promised to not do that again.’ (Faroese; Christensen 2007: 153)
- b. Eg kan ikkje lova {**å**} **aldri** {**å**} gjera det igjen.
 I can.PRS not promise.INF {**to**} never {**to**} do.INF it again
 ‘I cannot promise to never do it again.’ (Norwegian; Faarlund 2015: 1–2)
- c. ?Han hade **prövat** {**o**} **alltid** {***o**} **sagt** ifrån i tid.
 he had.PST try.PTCP {**to**} always {***to**} say.PTCP in-from in time
 ‘He had tried to always object in time.’ (Swedish; Wiklund 2007: 85)

Whatever the status of modals and infinitival markers in these languages, they cannot all be associated with the same position.

as opposed to, for example, ϕ -features (see Adger 2003).

- (23) a. $i\text{INFL}:\alpha_i \dots u\text{INFL}:_$ b. $i\text{INFL}:\alpha_i \dots u\text{INFL}:\underline{\alpha_i}$

In this *Reverse Agree* implementation, Agree searches upwards rather than downwards as in (Chomsky 2000, 2001 et seq.). Reverse Agree straightforwardly captures the dependency between verbal inflection and higher functional heads as in the case of Parasitic Participles (Wurmbrand 2012) and auxiliaries (Bjorkman 2011).¹²

Wurmbrand (2012) argues that in restructuring contexts, the complement clause can be so small that there is no functional head that contributes an interpretable verbal inflectional feature. Thus, a verb that is looking to be marked by such a feature can actually enter into an Agree relationship with a functional head in the higher clause, such as the perfect, via the intermediate restructuring verb, as schematized in (24b).

- (24) a. Han hade **kunnat** läst.
he had.PST can.PTCP read.PTCP
'He had been able to read.'
(Swedish; Wiklund 2007: 53)
- b.
-

Non-restructuring infinitival clauses are different as they are bigger, and they constitute their own extended projection. Wurmbrand (2012) models this intuition by assuming an extra functional head in such clauses, *Inf*, that contributes an infinitival feature and prevents parasitic agreement (25b).¹³ InfP thus acts as a domain boundary between different extended projections (as indicated by the boxed off section of the tree diagram in (25b)) which is optionally absent in restructuring contexts.¹⁴

- (25) a. Han hade **kunnat** läsa.
he had.PST can.PTCP read.INF
'He had been able to read.'
(Swedish; Wiklund 2007: 53)
- b.
-

This account ties the three main characteristics of Parasitic Participles together. The restructuring context is necessary since otherwise there will be a functional head which contributes an inflectional feature for the verb to depend on instead. Further, Parasitic Participles are vacuous morphology because the PERF-feature is only interpreted on *have*. Finally, the intervention effect arises since morphological selection is driven by syntactic agreement and Agree is crucially assumed to be restricted to the closest target.

These attributes provide an important argument for the idea that syntactic agreement can model selection of verbal morphology (Wiklund 2007, Wurmbrand 2012). In the next section, I introduce novel Faroese data which initially appear to present a problem for this theory since we see parasitic morphology which is not semantically vacuous and not restricted to restructuring contexts although it still obeys syntactic locality.

¹²For the purposes of this paper, I am not going to delve into the issue of whether agreement in general is *Downward* or *Upward*. It is possible to develop a *Downward Agree* version of Wurmbrand's (2012) account. Deal (2023) points out that through *goal flagging*, we could extend an *Interaction and Satisfaction* analysis to Parasitic Participles.

¹³Scandinavian infinitival markers cannot be equated with [INF] in Wurmbrand (2012) as they can occur with Parasitic Participles.

¹⁴Inf is the only functional head in Wurmbrand (2012) with no uninterpretable feature. This ensures that the extended projection is closed off.

3 The problem of Faroese

This section provides novel Faroese data which present an apparent problem for syntactic agreement accounts, namely Parasitic Participles that appear to have a semantic effect and further occur in non-restructuring complements. I show that Faroese Parasitic Participles do nevertheless behave in accordance with agreement accounts in that they obey syntactic locality effects. I also provide evidence for the conclusion that the behavior of Faroese Parasitic Participles is not due to semantic licensing but to a larger complement clause and an optionally silent *have*.

3.1 Faroese Parasitic Participles behave like syntactic agreement

Faroese has richer verbal inflection paradigms than Norwegian and Swedish, and it is often considered to occupy an intermediate syntactic position between Mainland Scandinavian languages and Icelandic (see, for instance, Holmberg and Platzack 1995, 2005, Thráinsson 2007 and Thráinsson et al. 2012). Nevertheless, the languages are very similar when it comes to past participles and the perfect. Like Norwegian and Swedish, Faroese forms the perfect with a *have*-auxiliary and a past participle (26a), made up of the verb stem and the participial suffix *-að/-ið/-t*, and optionally allows Parasitic Participles (26b).¹⁵

- (26) a. Eg **havi** **lisið** bókina.
I have.PRS read.PTCP book-the
'I have read the book.'
- b. Eg hevði **viljað** {lesa / **lisið**} bókina.
I had.PST wanted read.INF / read.PTCP book.the
'I had wanted to read / have read the book.'
- (Faroese)

Initially, Parasitic Participles appear much the same in Faroese as in Norwegian and Swedish. For instance, they are parasitic in that they occur when a perfect auxiliary embeds a participial restructuring verb such as the modal *can* or the implicative verb *manage* (27).

- (27) *Faroese Parasitic Participles in tenseless complements*
- a. Eg hevði **kunnað** {lesa / **lisið**}.
I had.PST can.PTCP read.INF / read.PTCP
'I had been able to read / have finished reading.'
- b. Hon hevur **nádd** at {lesa / **lisið**} bók-ina.
she has.PRS managed.PTCP to read.INF / read.PTCP book-the
'She has managed to read / have read the book.'
- (Faroese)

Parasitic Participles do not occur where the restructuring verb is not a participle, for instance, if it appears in the present or past tense (28).¹⁶

- (28) *No Faroese Parasitic Participles with verbs in the present or past tense*
- a. Eg kann {lesa / ***lisið**}.
I can.PRS read.INF / read.PTCP
'I can read.'
- b. Hon náddi at {lesa / ***lisið**} bók-ina.
she managed.PST to read.INF / read.PTCP book-the
'She managed to read the book.'
- (Faroese)

An important indication that Faroese Parasitic Participles also involve syntactic agreement comes from the same kind of intervention effect that we saw in Norwegian and Swedish (Thráinsson et al. 2012). The para-

¹⁵The interpretation difference indicated in the glosses for (26b) will be elaborated on in the next section.

¹⁶Past tense modals which can indeed license Parasitic Participles constitute the only exception to this pattern. The fact that only modals have this ability and only when they are in the past tense suggests that there is some additional factor at play. I set this aside here.

sitic morphology in Faroese must crucially spread locally from the closest c-commanding verbal head. If an infinitive structurally intervenes between participles, the construction is ungrammatical (29).¹⁷

(29) *Faroese Parasitic Participles spread locally*

- a. Hann hevur altíð **viljað** **kunnað** {*skilja* / **skilt**} italskt.
he have.PRS always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP understand.INF / understand.PTCP Italian
- b. Hann hevur altíð **viljað** {**kunna* / **kunnað**} **skilt** italskt.
he have.PRS always wanted.PTCP can.INF / can.PTCP understand.PTCP Italian
'He has always wanted to be able to understand Italian.' (Faroese)

This restriction indicates that just as in other instances of parasitic participial morphology, the higher participle needs to be in a local c-command relationship with the parasitic participle.

3.2 Interpretive effects of Faroese Parasitic Participles

Despite initial appearances, I will argue in this section that Parasitic Participles in Faroese are not interpreted as vacuous morphology and that instead they have a perfect reading. Before I present the meaning contrast between Parasitic Participles in Faroese and the other languages, I will briefly discuss the semantics of the perfect in finite and non-finite clauses in Scandinavian.

The Faroese perfect can convey the same three interpretations as in English: (a) An experiential, (b) resultative, or (c) universal reading (Petersen 2020). Here, we will focus on the *experiential perfect* (see e.g. Iatridou et al. 2003, Pancheva 2003).¹⁸ In the experiential reading of the perfect, the event denoted by the verb phrase has occurred at least once in the interval up to the present now (or *the reference time*; Reichenbach 1947). For instance, in (30), sometime before the utterance time, the speaker has been to Berlin twice.

(30) *Experiential perfect in English and Faroese*

- a. Alexandra **has** been in LA (before) (Pancheva 2003: 277)
- b. Eg **havi** verið í Berlin tvær ferðir.
I have.PRS been.PTCP in Berlin two times
'I have been to Berlin twice.' (Faroese; Petersen 2020)

While finite clauses are normally interpreted independently from the embedding context, infinitival clauses are either interpreted with a future orientation or as simultaneous with the matrix clause depending on the matrix verb (e.g. Stowell 1982, Landau 2004, Cowper 2005 and Wurmbrand 2014b). However, an infinitival perfect can have an experiential reading. The infinitival sentence in (31a) conveys an action that is simultaneous with the matrix clause while the infinitival perfect in (31b) conveys a previous occurrence of the action (31).

(31) *Infinitival Perfect in Faroese*

- a. Jógvan tykist *arbeiða* í Havn.
Jógvan seems work.INF in Tórshavn
'Jógvan seems to work in Tórshavn.'
- b. Jógvan tykist *hava* **arbeitt** í Havn.
Jógvan seems have.INF work.PTCP in Tórshavn
'Jógvan seems to have worked (have working experience) in Tórshavn.' (Faroese; Petersen 2020)

The perfect generally works in the same way in Norwegian and Swedish, in that it can encode an experiential reading (as well as a universal and recent past reading; Faarlund et al. 1997, Larsson 2009).

¹⁷I use the Faroese verb *skilja* 'understand' rather than *tosa* 'speak' in (29) as the participial form of the latter verb has an identical pronunciation as an infinitive and as a participle.

¹⁸Other readings of the perfect such as a 'hot news' / recent past reading and the Scandinavian inferential reading are set aside here (but see e.g. Larsson 2009).

(32) *Experiential perfects in Norwegian and Swedish*

- a. Siden 1976 **har** jeg vært innlagt i alt seks ganger.
 since 1976 have.PRS I been.PTCP hospitalized in all six times
 ‘Since 1976 I have been hospitalized six times.’
 (Norwegian; Grønn and von Stechow 2020: 30)
- b. Frida **har** besøkt Göteborg många gånger.
 Frida has.PRS visited.PTCP Gothenburg many times
 ‘Frida has visited Gothenburg many times.’
 (Swedish; Larsson 2009: 71)

Turning to Parasitic Participles, however, we find interpretive differences between the different languages. Parasitic Participles in Norwegian and Swedish do not have the expected perfect reading in examples like (31b). Instead, they are underspecified for tense and aspect (Wiklund 2007; Wurmbrand 2012). However, we will see that in Faroese they can have an experiential reading.

In order to assess the presence of semantic effects, I did fieldwork with two Faroese speakers as well as supplementary consultation with several other Faroese speakers. My fieldwork suggests that the semantic effect in Faroese is due to the participle being interpreted as a perfect. This can explain the contrasts that we find between an infinitive and a participle in the language. Below are examples where I have attempted to elicit experiential perfect readings based on diagnostics from the crosslinguistic survey in Bertrand et al. (2022).¹⁹

First, observe the example in (33) with *vilja* ‘want’ which requires an experiential reading. In Faroese, both the *have*-auxiliary (shown in brackets) and a past participle, as well as a Parasitic Participle can convey the felicitous experiential reading. However, the infinitive is infelicitously interpreted as simultaneous.

Context: The speaker is expressing regret over never having met their grandmother who has died.

- (33) Eg *havi* altíð **viljað** (*havt*) **møtt** / #*møta* ommu mínari.
 I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP have.PTCP meet.PTCP / meet.INF grandmother.DAT my.DAT
 ‘I have always wanted to have met my grandmother’
 (Faroese)
Consultant comment: ‘*møta* [i.e. the infinitive] does not work here. This needs to be *møtt* [i.e., the participle] since the grandmother has died.’

Now, recall Parasitic Participles have been observed to be semantically vacuous in other Germanic languages, including Swedish (Wiklund 2007).²⁰ To provide a minimal comparison for the interpretation of Parasitic Participles, I presented speakers of both Swedish, and Norwegian with the same example involving modal *want* that we saw in (33). For this example, both the infinitive and Parasitic Participle have an infelicitous reading (34)–(35). Instead, the felicitous experiential perfect reading is only possible with the *have*-auxiliary.

Context: The speaker is talking about their grandmother who died when they were young, and who the speaker regrets never having met.

(34) *Norwegian non-perfect Parasitic Participles*

- a. #Jeg har alltid **villet** **møtt** / *møta* mormoren min.
 I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP met.PTCP / meet.INF grandmother my
 # ‘I have always wanted to meet my grandmother.’ (implies grandmother is still alive)

¹⁹Causative verbs cannot be interpreted as perfect without an auxiliary in any of the three languages.

²⁰Wiklund (2007) only discusses a telicity contrast, not diagnostics for the perfect. She claims that the when the aspectual *börja* ‘begin’ selects the participle *läst* ‘read’ in (i), it cannot be interpreted with a specified end point. An end point is conveyed with *have* (ii).

- (i) a. Lars *hade* börjat o *läsa* / **läst** bok-en.
 Lars had.PST begun.PTCP to read.INF / read.PTCP book-the
 ‘Lars had begun to read the book.’
 b. Lars *hade* börjat to *ha* **läst** bok-en.
 Lars had.PST begun.PTCP to have.INF read.PTCP book-the
 ‘Lars had begun to have finished reading the book.’
 (Swedish; Wiklund 2007: 20)

Although this suggests that Swedish Parasitic Participles have different semantics from a normal perfect, this contrast does not clearly show that they are semantically vacuous or non-perfect.

- b. Jeg har alltid **villet** ha **møtt** mormoren min.
 I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP have.INF met.PTCP grandmother my
 ‘I have always wanted to have been able to meet my grandmother.’ (Norwegian)

(35) *Swedish non-perfect Parasitic Participles*

- a. #Jag har alltid **velat** **träffat** / *träffa* min mormor.
 I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP met.PTCP / meet.INF my grandmother
 # ‘I have always wanted to see my grandmother.’ (implies grandmother is still alive)
 b. Jag har alltid **velat** ha **träffat** min mormor.
 I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP have.INF met.PTCP my grandmother
 ‘I have always wanted to have been able to meet my grandmother.’ (Swedish)

I conclude that, unlike Faroese, Norwegian and Swedish Parasitic Participles are truly semantically vacuous, as previously argued for by Wiklund (2007).

In sum, there is a surprising semantic effect in Faroese Parasitic Participles even though it behaves like it respects syntactic locality. At first glance, this seems to be a problem for a syntactic agreement of parasitic morphology. An important clue as to what might be going on is that Parasitic Participles in Faroese also differ from the Norwegian and Swedish kind in being found in larger clauses.

3.3 Parasitic Participles in tensed complements

In this section, I show that Faroese Parasitic Participles are not restricted to tenseless complements like the Norwegian and Swedish constructions are. While Parasitic Participles in Faroese can occur with restructuring verbs, like modals, they also occur with verbs like *expect* and *promise* which take a tensed complement (36).

(36) *Faroese Parasitic Participles in tensed complements*

- a. Hann hevði **væntað**, at {*koma* / **komið**} heim í næstu viku.
 he had.PST expected.PTCP to come.INF / come.PTCP home in next week
 ‘He had expected to come home next week / to have come (by) next week.’
 b. Hann hevði **lovað**, at {*koma* / **komið**} heim í morgin.
 he had.PST promised.PTCP to come.INF / come.PTCP home tomorrow
 ‘He had promised to come home tomorrow / to have come home (by) tomorrow.’

The Faroese verb *lova* ‘promise’ can take an infinitive, a *have*-auxiliary and a past participle, or a bare participle complement. I will show that the participle complement has a perfect reading both with and without *have*.

The context for the example in (37) conveys that the activity is supposed to have been completed before the current time. Such a context excludes the infinitive due to its simultaneous interpretation. However, both the bare participle and the participle with *have* can convey the appropriate experiential reading.

Context: Annika is supposed to help with a party at noon. However, as Annika is running a marathon today the host is worried that she will not be back in time for the preparation. You tell the host not to worry, because:

- (37) Annika hevur **lovað**, at (**havt**) **runnið** maratonrenningin áðrenn middag.
 Annika has.PRS promised.PTCP to have.PTCP run.PTCP marathon.run.the before midday
 ‘Annika has promised to have run the marathon by noon.’ (Faroese)

Recall, however, that Norwegian and Swedish do not allow Parasitic Participles in tensed complements. Thus, the same options are not available for the verbs *love* ‘promise’ in Norwegian and *lova* ‘promise’ in Swedish (38). In the same context as in Faroese, a *have*-auxiliary is necessary to get the correct, non-simultaneous reading. A Parasitic Participle or infinitive do not allow for the appropriate reading in Norwegian and Swedish.

- (38) a. Annika har lovat att * (**ha**) **sprungit** maratonloppet före lunch.
 Annika has.PRS promised.PTCP to have.INF run.PTCP marathon.run.the before lunch
 ‘Annika has promised to have run the marathon before lunch.’ (Swedish)

- b. Annika *har* **lovet** *å* * (*ha*) **løpt** maratonet *før* lunsj.
 Annika has.PRS promised.PTCP to have.INF run.PTCP marathon.the before lunch
 ‘Annika has promised to have run the marathon before lunch.’ (Norwegian)

A bare participle complement with a perfect interpretation is not restricted to control verbs like *promise* and *expect* in Faroese. The Exceptional Case-Marking (ECM) verb *believe* can similarly take a complement with Parasitic Participle. In (39), the preferred reading is experiential and it can be conveyed with the perfect but not with an infinitive. To the degree that an infinitive is even grammatical, it is infelicitous in this context.

Context: The speaker is explaining why Luke Skywalker in Star Wars was angry with Darth Vader up until the final film in the series.

- (39) Luke hevði **hildið** Darth Vader (**havt**) **dripið** / # *drepa* pápa sín.
 Luke had.PST believed.PTCP Darth Vader (have.PTCP) killed.PTCP / kill.INF father his
 ‘Luke had believed Darth Vader to have killed his father.’ (Faroese)

However, similar ECM examples in Norwegian and Swedish ECM do not allow Parasitic Participles. They are only acceptable with an overt *have* and only in these cases do they have the expected perfect reading (40)–(41).

(40) *Norwegian ECM perfect*

- a. *Luke *hadde* **trodd** ham *å* {*drepe* / **drept**} sin pappa.
 Luke had.PST believed.PTCP him to kill.INF / killed.PTCP his father
 ‘Luke had believed him to have killed his father.’
 b. Luke *hadde* **trodd** ham *å* *ha* **drept** sin pappa.
 Luke had.PST believed.PTCP him to have.INF killed.PTCP his father
 ‘Luke had believed him to have killed his father.’ (Norwegian)

(41) *Swedish ECM Perfect*

- a. *Luke *hade* **ansett** honom {*döda* / **dödat**} sin pappa.
 Luke had.PST considered.PTCP him kill.INF / killed.PTCP his father
 ‘Luke had believed him to have killed his father’
 b. Luke *hade* **ansett** honom *ha* **dödat** sin pappa.
 Luke had.PST considered.PTCP him have.INF killed.PTCP his father
 ‘Luke had believed him to have killed his father.’ (Swedish)

I conclude that Faroese Parasitic Participles are not dependent on tenseless complements, unlike Norwegian and Swedish, and can instead occur in larger complements. Interestingly, Faroese tenseless complements generally allow an embedded perfect *have* auxiliary (42). In these cases, *have* must be in the participial form.

- (42) a. Eg hevði **kunnað** **havt** **lisið**.
 I had.PST can.PTCP have.PTCP read.PTCP
 ‘I had been able to have finished reading.’
 b. Hon hevði nádd at **havt** **lisið** bók-ina.
 she had.PST managed.PTCP to have.PTCP read.PTCP book-the
 ‘She managed to read / have read the book.’ (Faroese)

Norwegian and Swedish, on the other hand, do not allow a second *have* auxiliary in tenseless complements (although they do allow them in tensed infinitivals). Unlike Faroese, *have* is always an infinitive in these case in Swedish (43) and Norwegian (44) as there is no participial form of the auxiliary.

- (43) a. ??Han *hade* **kunnat** *ha* **läst**.
 he had.PST can.PTCP have.INF read.PTCP
 Intended: ‘He had been able to have read.’
 b. *Jag *hade* **låt** det *ha* **kommit** fem personer.
 I had.PST let.PTCP it have.INF come.PTCP five people

- Intended: ‘I had let five people have come.’
- c. ??Jag hade **hunnit** *ha* **läst** bok-en.
 I had.PST managed.PTCP have.INF read.PTCP book-the.
 Intended: ‘I had managed to read the book.’ (Swedish)
- (44) a. ??Han hadde **kunnet** *ha* **lest**.
 he had.PST can.PTCP have.INF read.PTCP
 ‘He had been able to have read.’
- b. *Jeg hadde **latt** det *ha* **gått** for langt.
 I had.PST let.PTCP it have.INF go.PTCP too far
 Intended: ‘I had let it have gone too far.’
- c. ??Jeg hadde klart å *ha* **lest** bok-en.
 I had.PST managed.PTCP to have.INF read.PTCP book-the
 Intended: ‘I had managed to read the book.’ (Norwegian)

I assume that the possibility of the perfect auxiliary *have* indicates the presence of extra functional structure in Faroese following work where clausal inflection is associated with dedicated functional heads (e.g. Tenny 1987; Demirdache and Uribe-Etxebarria 2000; Bjorkman 2011).

In sum, only in Faroese do Parasitic Participles have a perfect reading, occur in tensed complements and require non-finite *have* to appear in a participial form. While I do not assume that true restructuring plays a role in the licensing of Parasitic Participles in Faroese, I will nonetheless argue that they are the result of syntactic agreement in a structurally reduced clause (cf. Wiklund 2007; Wurmbrand 2012).

4 Parasitic Participles in Faroese as HAVE-omission

This section shows that Faroese confirms a prediction of the Agree analysis of parasitic morphology. Namely, that auxiliaries should be able to participate in parasitic agreement under the right conditions, that is, if there is no intervening head that contributes an interpretable feature. I argue that this is the case in Faroese where *have* participates in parasitic agreement because non-finite clauses that have the perfect in them do not have a head that licenses infinitives. The lack of an infinitive-head explains both why the parasitic morphology spreads on to *have* and why it is obligatory. I then show that the same explanation also accounts for why Parasitic Participles in Faroese appear to have a different distribution and different interpretation: Such clauses always involve a *have* but this is obscured by an independent process of auxiliary omission.

4.1 Parasitic morphology targets HAVE-auxiliary

In this section, we will see how the parasitic morphology on *have* in Faroese provides a clue to the nature of Faroese Parasitic Participles. The Faroese perfect auxiliary *have* is unique in Scandinavian in that when it is c-commanded by another perfect auxiliary, *have* can itself be a Parasitic Participle (45). Like other parasitic morphology, the participial morphology on *have* does not have any extra meaning associated with it.

- (45) Hon hevði **nádd** at **havt** **lisið** bók-ina.
 she had.PST managed.PTCP to have.PTCP read.PTCP book-the
 ‘She managed to have read the book.’

Elsewhere, non-finite *have* appears in the infinitive, such as when it is selected by a present tense modal (46).

- (46) Hann skal *hava* **etið** eitt súrepli.
 he shall.PRS have.INF eat.PTCP an apple
 ‘He supposedly ate an apple.’ (Faroese)

In fact, the Faroese perfect auxiliary must be in the participial form if it is c-commanded by another participle.

Infinitival *have* is ungrammatical in the same context (47).²¹

- (47) Tú hevur **roynt** at **havt** / * *hava* **lisið** Bíbliuna í hvørt fall.
 you have.PRS tried.PTCP to have.PTCP / have.INF read.PTCP bible-the in any case
 ‘You (must) have in any case tried to have finished reading the bible.’ (Faroese)

In contrast, the Norwegian and Swedish perfect auxiliary can only appear in the infinitive in Parasitic Participle configurations (48).

- (48) a. Hon hadde villet *ha* **lest** bibel-en.
 she had.PST want.PTCP have.INF read.PTCP Bible-the
 ‘She had wanted to have finished reading the Bible.’ (Norwegian)
 b. Hon hade velat *ha* **läst** Bibel-n.
 she had.PST want.PTCP have.INF read.PTCP Bible-the
 ‘She had wanted to have finished reading the Bible.’ (Swedish)

This same contrast between Faroese, and Norwegian and Swedish, arises with past tense modals. Importantly, there is one context in which Scandinavian Parasitic Participles can occur without the presence of *have*, namely when preceded by a past tense modal (49). In Faroese, past tense modals can, and for some speakers must, take a participial complement (49a).²²

- (49) a. Hann skuldi **kunnað etið** eitt súrepli.
 he should.PST can.PTCP eat.PTCP an apple
 ‘He should be able / have been able to eat an apple.’ (Faroese)
 b. Han skulle **kunnet spiset** et eple.
 he should.PST can.PTCP eat.PTCP an apple
 ‘He should be able / have been able to eat an apple.’ (Norwegian)
 c. Han skulle **kunnat ätit** ett äpple.
 he should.PST can.PTCP eat.PTCP an apple
 ‘He should be able / have been able to eat an apple.’ (Swedish)

Past tense modals can also select a *have*-auxiliary (50) but this *have* appears in different forms depending on the language. In Norwegian and Swedish, past tense modals select infinitival *have*. However, in Faroese, they select a participial *have* (Thráinsson et al. 2012).

- (50) a. Hann skuldi **havt etið** eitt súrepli.
 he should.PST have.PTCP eat.PTCP an apple
 ‘He should have eaten an apple.’ (Faroese)
 b. Han skulle *ha* **spiset** et eple.
 he should.PST have.INF eaten.PTCP an apple
 ‘He should have eaten an apple.’ (Norwegian)
 c. Han skulle *ha* **ätit** ett äpple.
 he should.PST have.INF eat.PTCP an apple
 ‘He should have eaten an apple.’ (Swedish)

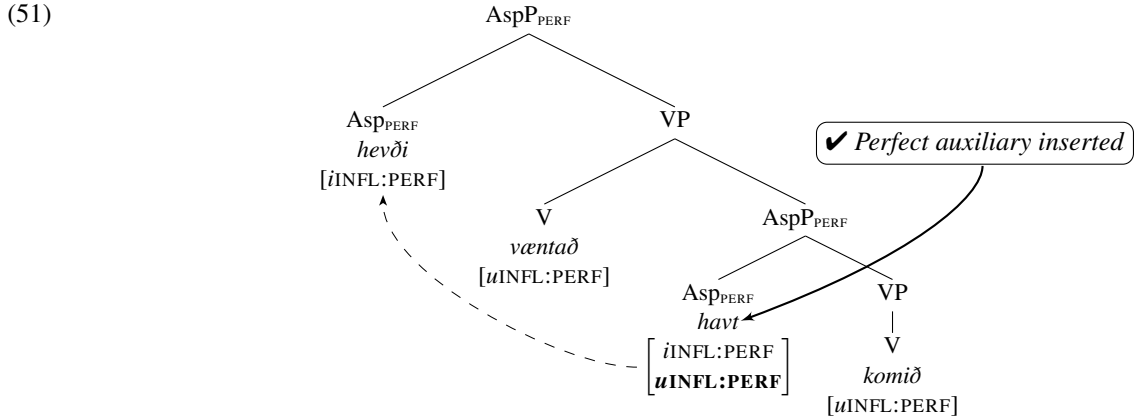
At first glance, the appearance of a participial *have* in Faroese Parasitic Participle configurations is surprising. Importantly, however, these examples confirm a natural prediction of the syntactic agreement approach (Wiklund 2007, Wurmbrand 2012). Namely, parasitic morphology can target any head carrying an uninterpretable probe ($[u\text{INFL}]$), not just verbs, if there is no other intervening head carrying a valued feature. A functional head could thus also be the target of parasitic morphology if it is possible to have an uninterpretable probe at the left edge of the clause. I argue that this is precisely what we see in Faroese.

I adopt Bjorkman’s (2011) analysis of auxiliaries as support for stranded affixes. Bjorkman assumes that

²¹It is not obvious why infinitival *have* cannot occur in a Parasitic Participle clause. The account in Section 4.3 explains the restriction.

²²The three languages have other verbs which take participial complements, like GET, but they do not license Parasitic Participles.

Agree gives rise to auxiliaries when a [*uINFL*]-feature fails to combine with the lexical verb and is stranded on a functional head. By default, a stranded [*uINFL*]-feature is pronounced in the lowest position in an Agree-chain. I take the perfect auxiliary to reflect a stranded [*uINFL*]-feature on $\text{AspP}_{\text{PERF}}$. I assume that Faroese has a complement type which has a perfect but does not have an Inf-feature (I will discuss the reduced clause types that are omitted in Faroese in more detail in the next section). If this complement type is embedded under a perfect, the uninterpretable probe on the embedded $\text{AspP}_{\text{PERF}}$ agrees with [*iINFL:PERF*] in the matrix clause and realizes participial *have* due to a [*uINFL:PERF*]-feature on the Asp-head, as schematized in (51).



Crucially, the possibility of participial *have* is predicted given the syntactic agreement account of verbal inflection together with the lack of an Inf-feature in Faroese.

4.2 Faroese Parasitic Participles do not involve restructuring

In this section, I explain why *have* obligatorily participates in Parasitic Participle constructions in Faroese. Recall that Parasitic Participles in Faroese occur in structurally larger complements than in Norwegian and Swedish. While the latter two languages only allow Parasitic Participles in tenseless complements, Faroese Parasitic Participles can occur in tensed complements with verbs like *expect* and *promise* (52).

- (52) a. Hann hevði **væntað**, at {*koma* / **komið**} heim í næstu viku.
 he had.PST expected.PTCP to come.INF / come.PTCP home in next week
 ‘He had expected to have come (by) next week.’
 b. Hann hevði **lovað**, at {*koma* / **komið**} heim í morgin.
 he had.PST promised.PTCP to come.INF / come.PTCP home tomorrow
 ‘He had promised to have come home (by) tomorrow.’ (Faroese)

I propose that the difference between the Scandinavian languages is due to these verbs selecting different sizes of complements and the resulting restrictions on these two complement types. I adopt Wurmbrand and Lohninger’s (2023) three-way distinction of semantic complement types, argued to be crosslinguistically stable, into temporally independent *Proposition complements*, more temporally dependent *Situation complements* and fully temporally dependent *Event complements* (cf. Ramchand and Svenonius 2014). See the hierarchy in (53).

- (53) *Implicational Complementation Hierarchy* ($X > Y = X$ is larger than Y)
Proposition > Situation > Event

Event complements are found under what we have previously termed *restructuring verbs*, for instance, modals and aspectuals. Situation and Proposition complements, on the other hand, occur with tensed verbs such as *promise* and *believe*.²³ Crucially, Wurmbrand and Lohninger (2023) argue that, despite the stable se-

²³Wurmbrand and Lohninger (2023) present a longer list of predicates for each complement type, and sort *promise* into Situation-embedding verbs and *believe* into Proposition-embedding verbs. For the sake of simplicity, I will set Proposition complements aside. The

mantic complement types, there is syntactic variation in the clause size that the complement types can be associated with. An Event complement, for instance, need not be realized by the smallest syntactic structure, VP. It could equally be realized by a, necessarily semantically inert, richer syntactic structure like TP or CP.

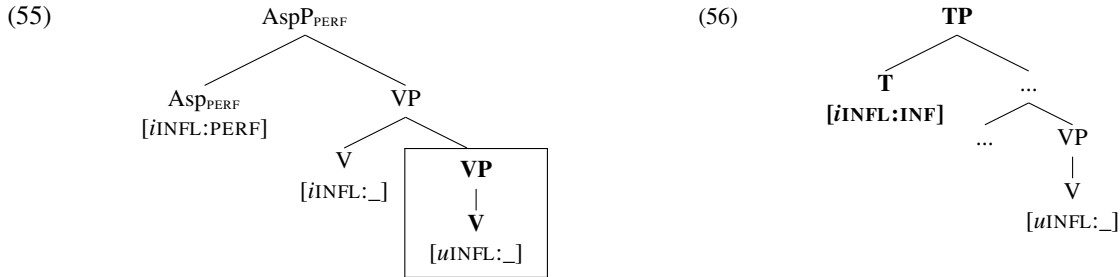
Moving forward it will be important that I adopt a particular view of what non-finiteness is. Following Wurmbrand (2012), I assume that an interpretable inflectional feature introduces non-finiteness to encode a domain boundary between different extended projections. I differ from Wurmbrand in assuming that non-finiteness is not determined by a dedicated functional head like Inf. Instead, I propose that it instantiates different flavours of a default functional head. I propose that this head is regulated by a Last Resort Condition on Merge (see Abels 2003, Wurmbrand 2014a for similar conditions on Merge). Namely, a valued functional head can only be merged to satisfy an unvalued probe (54).

(54) *Last Resort Condition on Merge*

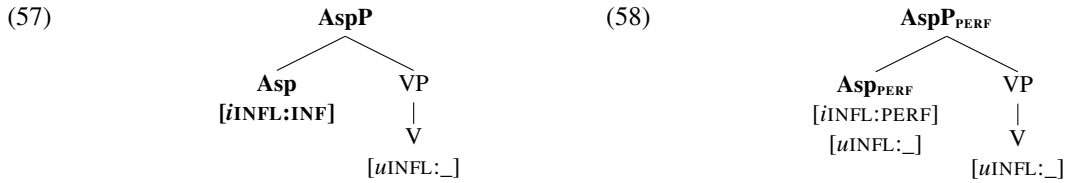
Only Merge a functional head to an XP if it leads to the satisfaction of an unvalued feature in XP within the same extended projection.

The condition in (54) has the effect that the functional head closes off the extended projection (like the Inf-head in Wurmbrand 2012).²⁴ However, since I do not assume a dedicated position for this head, it may be introduced at distinct points in different languages. Importantly, this distinction can derive parasitic *have* in Faroese.

For Norwegian and Swedish, I assume that Event complements are bare VPs. In these complements, the verb parasitically agrees with a value in the higher clause via the restructuring verb (55), while the non-finite feature [*i*INFL:INF] occurs on T in non-finite clauses. In other words, Norwegian and Swedish infinitival complements correspond to Situation sized TPs (56). (The tree diagrams gloss over projections not discussed in the prose).



In contrast, Faroese Event complements are syntactically the size of a Situation complement. True Parasitic Participles are excluded in the language as they require a smaller complement. Instead, parasitic morphology is only licensed via *have*. I propose that the feature that triggers infinitival morphology occurs on Asp in Faroese, and not on T as in Norwegian and Swedish (57). The perfect, however, is realized by AspP_PERF which has an interpretable Perf-feature and a probe on the left periphery of the clause that triggers parasitic morphology (58).



The perfect cannot occur in infinitival clauses since it is actually in complementary distribution with true infinitival morphology. Instead, I assume that the apparent infinitival form of *have* spells out failed agreement along the lines of Preminger (2014) (I will discuss this idea in more detail in the next section).²⁵ This intuition

important distinction is whether complements are Event complements or larger.

²⁴Importantly, the last resort condition on Inf cannot preclude selection from a higher head. However, for the purposes of this paper, I will set this aside here and leave a more precise proposal for future research.

²⁵I assume that there is a morphological well-formedness condition which requires verbs to have some inflectional marking, in the sense of Lasnik (1995), and that the infinitive can serve that function in the absence of any other marking.

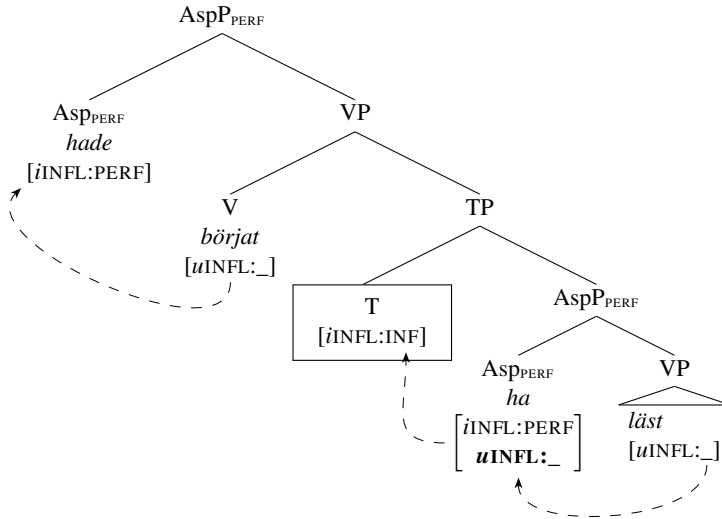
relates to the fact that when *have* cannot copy the inflection of the higher verb, as in (61a), it reverts to the infinitive form.

Similarly, the fact that the Inf-feature occurs on a T-head in Norwegian and Swedish also affects the morphology of the perfect. In these languages, a true non-finite perfect always requires an infinitival *have*. An example of this is shown with the modal *ville* ‘want’ which is a restructuring verb in all three languages (59).

- (59) a. Jeg har alltid **villet** ha **møtt** mormoren min.
 I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP have.INF met.PTCP grandmother my
 ‘I have always wanted to have been able to meet my grandmother.’ (Norwegian)
- b. Jag har alltid **velat** ha **träffat** min mormor.
 I have.PRS always wanted have.INF met.PTCP my grandmother
 ‘I have always wanted to have been able to meet my grandmother.’ (Swedish)

Since this clause has a second *have* and an embedded perfect interpretation, they must be larger than infinitival and Parasitic Participle complements. Within the current proposal, this is because the Norwegian and Swedish non-finite perfect auxiliary, realized on $\text{AspP}_{\text{PERF}}$, is always directly embedded under a T head carrying a valued Inf-feature. Accordingly, non-finite *have* always surfaces as an infinitive in these languages (60).

- (60) Norwegian and Swedish non-finite perfect



Unlike Parasitic Participle configurations, no two verbs in (60) agree with the same inflectional feature. For this reason, a second overt infinitival *have* gives rise to a perfect interpretation.

4.3 The Faroese perfect auxiliary cannot copy tense

A major problem for all inflection-as-agreement approaches is that they do not provide an explanation for why certain inflectional features are copied but not others. Such approaches predict that other morphology besides participles ought to also be parasitic. However, we do not find other kinds of parasitic inflection such as tense or passive morphology. This general problem arises in my analysis as well. Given the structure that I proposed for parasitic *have* in (51), we might expect that *have* could copy other inflectional features such as tense. Importantly, however, the Faroese perfect auxiliary cannot copy tensed inflection. Whenever perfect *have* is selected by a tensed verb, such as present tense modals, *have* appears in its infinitival form (61a). A tensed perfect auxiliary in a non-finite clause is ungrammatical (61b).

- (61) a. Hann skal **hava** etið eitt súrepli.
 he shall.PRS have.INF eat.PTCP an apple

- b. *Hann skal hevur etið eitt súrepli.
 he shall.PRS have.PRS eat.PTCP an apple
 ‘He supposedly ate an apple.’

(Faroese)

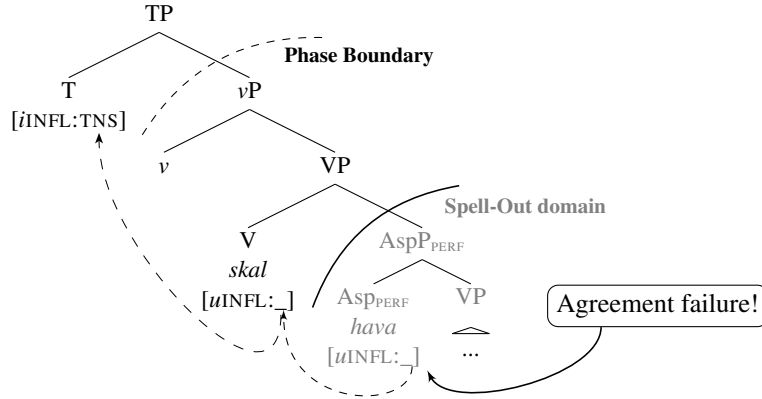
Here, I will sketch an explanation for why this is not possible. I argue that tense copying is not normally possible across clauses due to the Phase Impenetrability Condition (PIC). I assume the weak version of the PIC, following Chomsky (2001: 14) which I define as in (62).

(62) **Weak Phase Impenetrability Condition (PIC)**

The domain of a phase head becomes inaccessible after the next phase head has been merged.

In the present context, (62) guarantees that a verb in the domain of the first phase head can only agree with inflectional heads that are merged before the next phase head. I assume a dynamic phasehood approach in which the highest projection of the VP domain is a phase and its complement is a Spell-Out domain (see Wurmbrand 2014a). The highest projection of the VP domain is either a lexical verb or an auxiliary like perfect *have*, so under our current assumptions the relevant phase is either a vP or $AspP$. Accordingly, an embedded perfect auxiliary should only see as far as the vP or $AspP$ of the matrix clause. By the time TP is merged, the embedded $AspP$ has already been transferred to Spell-Out (63).

(63)



I propose that when Asp fails to receive a value, due to the PIC, it appears in its default form: the infinitive (see Preminger 2014 on failed agreement). Evidence that verbs in the Scandinavian languages cannot normally copy tense comes from pseudo-coordination. Only motion verbs and certain aspectual verbs allow pseudo-coordination and in these instances tense copying is exceptionally possible (64).

- (64) a. Han **sitter** og **skriver** dikt.
 he sits.PRS and writes.PRS poems
 ‘He is writing poetry.’
 b. Eg **standi** og **hugsi** um Lenu.
 I stand.PRS.SG and think.PRS.SG about Lena
 ‘I am thinking about Lena.’
 c. Han **började** o **läste** boken.
 he started.PST and read.PST book.the
 ‘He started reading the book.’

(Norwegian; Lødrup 2002)

(Faroese; Heycock and Petersen 2012)

(Swedish; Wiklund 2007)

This suggests that the phase boundary between the embedded verb and tense is exceptionally absent for these constructions. I assume that in (64), both verbs are contained within the Spell-Out domain and so they can see as far as the next phase head, C . As a result, the embedded verb can copy tense on T .

This analysis correctly predicts that Faroese *have* should only be able to copy participial morphology. No other relevant verb, such as a progressive form, can be copied in the language. However, a remaining question for inflection-as-agreement approaches in general is how to restrict agreement to the attested patterns of

parasitic inflection. I leave this crosslinguistic problem for future work.²⁶

4.4 Faroese allows a silent non-finite HAVE

In this section, I will draw on an independent process of *have*-omission in the participle complements of past tense modals to explain Faroese Parasitic Participles.²⁷ As in the case of Parasitic Participles, past tense modals can take bare participle complements in Faroese (65).

- (65) a. Hon hevði ynskt at **verið** á Woodstock.
 she had.PST wished.PTCP to been.PTCP at Woodstock
 ‘She had wanted to have gone to Woodstock.’
 b. Hon kundi **farið**, um hon vildi.
 she could.PST gone.PTCP if she had wanted.to
 ‘She could have gone if she had wanted to.’

In both cases, the interpretation is the same whether or not *have* is present. This is illustrated for Parasitic Participles in the experiential context in (66) where a participle with or without *have* is equally grammatical.

Context: Imagine that you have an elderly mother who is upset because she couldn’t go to Woodstock in 1969. Your friend asks why she is upset, and you answer:

- (66) a. Hon hevði ynskt at **havið** verið á Woodstock.
 she had.PST wished.PTCP to have.PTCP been.PTCP at Woodstock
 b. Hon hevði ynskt at **verið** á Woodstock.
 she had.PST wished.PTCP to been.PTCP at Woodstock
 ‘She had wanted to have gone to Woodstock.’

Similarly, a past tense modal with participial complement has a perfect reading as illustrated in (67). The felicitous reading can be conveyed with a *have*-auxiliary and participial complement or a bare participle.

Context: Your mother regrets not having gone to Woodstock in 1969. Your dad is not sympathetic and says:

- (67) a. Hon kundi **havið** farið, um hon vildi.
 she could.PST have.PTCP gone.PTCP if she wanted.PST
 b. Hon kundi **farið**, um hon vildi.
 she could.PST gone.PTCP if she wanted.PST

²⁶Norwegian and Swedish also allow what appears to be parasitic passive morphology (i).

- (i) a. En journalist **påstås** **mördad** in Gaza.
 a journalist claim.PASS murdered.PASS in Gaza
 ‘It is claimed that a journalist has been murdered in Gaza.’ (Swedish; Engdahl 2022: 14)
 b. Arbeidene **ventes** **avsluttet** innen 8. august.
 works.DEF expect.PASS finished.PASS before 8 August
 ‘The works are expected to be finished before August 8.’ (Norwegian; Faarlund et al. 1997: 850)

However, unlike Parasitic Participles in these languages, the examples in (i) involve non-restructuring verbs like *påstå* ‘consider and *vente* ‘expect’. This suggests that these examples are not the same kind of parasitic agreement as Parasitic Participles. As Faroese does not appear to allow this construction, I set such examples aside here.

²⁷Another illustrative comparison comes from a process of auxiliary omission in Swedish. In Swedish, finite *have* can be optionally omitted in non-V2-clauses (Julien 2002).

- (i) a. Vi anser att hon ~~har~~ blivit illa behandlad.
 we consider.PRS that she have.PRS become.PTCP badly treated
 ‘We think that she has been badly treated.’
 b. Jag mötte henne när hon ~~hade~~ flyttat till Sundsvall.
 I met.PST her when she have.PST moved.PTCP to Sundsvall
 ‘I met her after she had moved to Sundsvall.’ (Swedish; Julien 2002: 75)

As Faroese does not have finite *have*-omission, I set this aside. See Snorrason (2025) for a deletion approach to Swedish *have*-omission.

‘She could have gone if she had wanted to.’

I propose that Faroese Parasitic Participles derive from an independent process of *have*-omission. A silent *have* can make sense of the perfect interpretation of a bare participle without any additional assumptions. Further, it can explain parasitic morphology in non-restructuring complements as it provides an agreement link between the matrix verb and the embedded verb. A Faroese sentence like (68a) consequently has the underlying form in (68b).

(68) *Silent have analysis of Faroese Parasitic Participles*

- a. Eg *havi* altíð **viljað** **møtt** ommu mínari.
 I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP meet.PTCP grandmother.DAT my.DAT
- b. Eg *havi* altíð **viljað** **havt** **møtt** ommu mínari.
 I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP have.PTCP meet.PTCP grandmother.DAT my.DAT
 ‘I have always wanted to have met my grandmother’ (Faroese)

As I assume that Event complements are excluded from Faroese, Faroese cannot have true Parasitic Participles. Instead, I propose that Faroese non-finite *have* can Agree with the perfect and give rise to apparent Parasitic Participles and the interpretative effect via an independent process of *have*-omission.

If Faroese Parasitic Participles involve silent *have*, their interpretive effect receives a natural explanation. The assumption also ties into the behavior of *have* in a different context. Whatever one says about *have*-omission, one has to accept that the same process occurs with Parasitic Participles and past tense modals (69).

- (69) a. Eg hevði **kunnað** (**havt**) **lisið**.
 I had.PST can.PTCP have.PTCP read.PTCP
 ‘I had been able to have finished reading.’
- b. Hann hevði **lovað**, at (**havt**) **komið** heim ímorgin.
 he had.PST promised.PTCP to have.PTCP come.PTCP home tomorrow
 ‘He had promised to have come home (by) tomorrow.’ (Faroese)

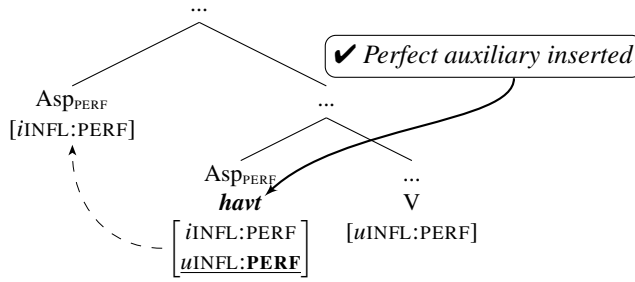
I offer one way of understanding *have*-omission. Namely, I propose that omission of participial *have* is a deletion operation which reflects the marked status of the auxiliary form, as discussed in the next section.

4.5 HAVE-omission as impoverishment

This section discusses the question of how *have*-omission arises within the model that I propose. Importantly, my proposal for *have*-omission is independent of what I have proposed in previous sections, and my previous proposals are consequently compatible with other explanations for *have*-omission. I argue that Faroese *have*-omission is a morphological dissimilation effect due to two co-occurring perfect features. I model the effect as *impoverishment*, i.e., deletion of the feature [*u*INFL:PERF] on the perfect head causes *have* to go unpronounced. I argue that the perfect head can only host one perfect feature, its inherent [*i*INFL:PERF], and that that impoverishment acts as a repair when an [*u*INFL:PERF] occurs on the same head. Similarly, clitic hosts in languages like Basque and Choctaw can only attract a single clitic, and consequently delete any extra clitic attached to the same host (Arregi and Nevins 2012, Tyler 2019).

Recall that I assume that morphology is passed down to the lexical verb via Agree (e.g. Wurmbrand 2012) and that auxiliaries act as support for stranded affixes (Bjorkman 2011). Thus, the participial form of the perfect auxiliary reflects a stranded [*u*INFL]-feature on Asp_{PERF} (70).

(70)



I argue that Faroese *have*-omission is triggered by a markedness constraint on co-occurring perfect features. Following much work in morphological theory (Bonet 1991, Noyer 1992, 1998 and many more), I model this markedness constraint with morphological deletion. I argue that the stranded feature $[uINFL:PERF]$ on Asp_{PERF} can be deleted via the rule in (71). Without a stranded $[uINFL]$ -feature on Perf, the *have*-auxiliary is not inserted.²⁸

(71) *Faroese Perfect Impoverishment rule*

For a node Asp_{PERF} where $[iINFL:PERF]$, $[uINFL:PERF]$ co-occur,
delete $[uINFL:PERF]$.

Another way of modeling *have*-omission is *obliteration*, or node deletion.²⁹ I make use of impoverishment as I assume, following e.g. Bjorkman (2011) and Wurmbrand (2012, 2014a), that only uninterpretable features get realized at PF. Accordingly, a fully impoverished functional head cannot trigger an auxiliary. Interpretable features, like $[iINFL:PERF]$, only correspond to the semantic value of the head and are not overtly realized. Similarly, impoverished lexical verbs cannot be omitted due to their unique lexical content.

An indication that participial marking on the perfect auxiliary is a marked combination comes from the fact that the possessive *have* cannot be similarly deleted in its participial form if the sentence is to retain the same meaning (72).

- (72) Trolarin hevur ***(havl)** eitt sera gott ár í ár.
trawler.the has.PRS have.PTCP a very good year in year
'The trawler has had a very good year this year.'

The example in (72) provides evidence that it is not the phonological form which triggers omission but specifically the participial form of the perfect. This is because possessive *have* does not carry the perfect feature. I argue that when the features licensing the perfect and the past participle co-occur on the same head, the impoverishment rule in (71) is triggered, deleting the marked feature combination.

Similar dissimilation cases are found crosslinguistically (see overview in Nevins 2012). In general, we do not expect inflectional categories to be recursive so it seems natural that double perfect feature marking would be a marked combination. In fact, it is only due to parasitic morphology that participial *have* is available in Faroese. Nevertheless, recursive morphology on the same head is found in other languages, like recursive causative morphology in Turkish and varieties of Japanese (Nie 2020, 2025). Both varieties can form a sentence consisting of a caused event and two causing events with double causative marking on the same verb stem. In Turkish, the causative affix *-t/-Dir* (which shows phonologically conditioned allomorphy) occurs twice (73a).

²⁸Note that whichever type of rule causes *have*-omission in Faroese, it must result in the deletion of the auxiliary. As we saw earlier, reducing the participle to an infinitive (the unmarked non-finite form) is ungrammatical in Parasitic Participles.

- (i) Tú hevur **roynt** at **havl** / **hava* **lisið** Bíbliuna í hvørt fall.
you have.PRS tried.PTCP to have.PTCP / have.INF read.PTCP bible-the in any case
'You (must) have in any case tried to have finished reading the bible.'
(Faroese)

²⁹Arregi and Nevins (2012) use Obliteration to model Participant dissimilation in the Basque of Zamudio where a clitic specified for [+participant] and either [+author] or [Ergative] is deleted in the context of a clitic with the same feature. Arregi and Nevins (2012) propose that Participant Dissimilation rules are triggered by a markedness constraint which explicitly prevents an auxiliary word from containing two clitics with [+participant] and either [+author] or [Ergative].

In Hokkaido Japanese, the causative affix *-ase/-sase* (which also shows allomorphy), is repeated (73b).

- (73) a. Anne-si Ayşe-ye Mary-yi oyna-**t-t**-dī
 mother-3SG.POSS Ayşe-DAT Mary-ACC play-CAUS-CAUS-PST
 ‘Her mother made Ayşe make Mary play.’ (Turkish; Nie 2025)
- b. %George-ga Naomi-ni Ken-ni tabako-o suw-**ase-sase**-ru.
 George-NOM Naomi-DAT Ken-DAT cigarette-ACC smoke-CAUS-CAUS-PRS
 ‘George will make Naomi make Ken get up.’ (Hokkaido Japanese; Nie 2020: 188)

Strikingly parallel to Faroese, both languages can retain the same meaning with one causative marker (74).

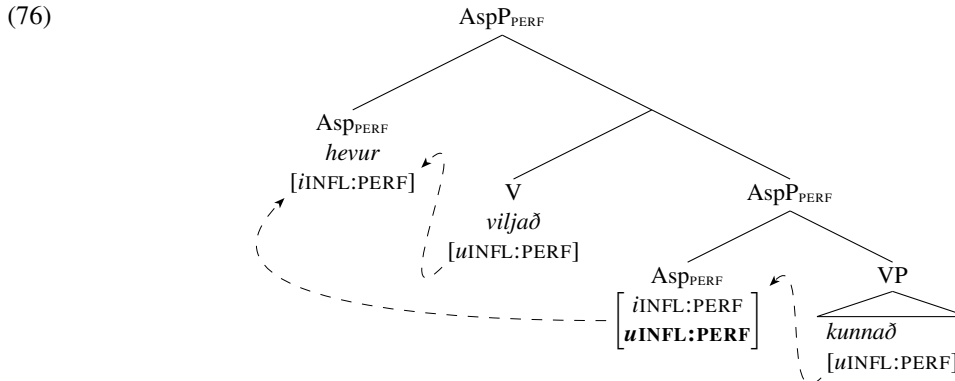
- (74) a. Anne-si Ayşe-ye Mary-yi oyna-**t-ti**
 mother-3SG.POSS Ayşe-DAT Mary-ACC play-CAUS-PST
 ‘Her mother made Ayşe make Mary play.’ (Turkish; Nie 2025)
- b. %George-ga getsuyoubi-ni Naomi-ni kayoubi-ni Ken-ni suiyoubi-ni tabako-o
 George-NOM Monday-DAT Naomi-DAT Tuesday-DAT Ken-DAT Wednesday-DAT cigarette-ACC
 suw-**(ase)-sase**-ta.
 smoke-CAUS-CAUS-PST
 ‘George will make Naomi make Ken get up.’ (Hokkaido Japanese; Nie 2020: 189)

For both Turkish and Japanese, a double causative structure with a single causative marker has been argued to involve dissimilatory deletion (Nie 2020), precisely as argued for Faroese Parasitic Participles in this paper.³⁰ Thus, the recursive morphology and dissimilatory deletion in Faroese have close parallels in other languages.

With the perfect deletion rule in place, we can now derive Parasitic Participles in Faroese. First, recall that when verbs like *vilja* are embedded under a perfect auxiliary and select verbal complement (75), they can either select an infinitive (in *italics*) or a Parasitic Participle (in **bold**).

- (75) a. Hann hevur altíð **viljað** *kunna skilja* italskt.
 he have.PRS always wanted.PTCP can.INF understand.INF Italian
 ‘He has always wanted to be able to understand Italian.’
- b. Hann hevur altíð **viljað** **kunnað skilt** italskt.
 he have.PRS always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP understand.PTCP Italian
 ‘He has always wanted to have been able to understand Italian.’ (Faroese)

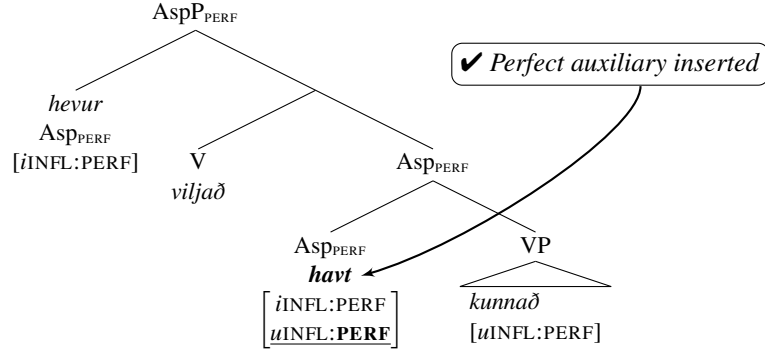
As before, I assume that participial morphology reflects syntactic agreement. Further, I assume that situation complements in Faroese are either an Asp-head that comes with a Inf-feature, or an Asp-head with a Perf-feature and an uninterpretable probe. Parasitic Participles arise in a structure with an AspP_{PERF} where the perfect auxiliary is merged with an unvalued [*u*INFL:PERF]-feature and a valued [*i*INFL:PERF]-feature. Consequently, each verbal head, including the perfect, will agree with [*i*INFL:PERF] and realize a participle (76).



³⁰Martinovic (2015) similarly argues that in Wolof, morphological dissimilation is triggered when the same phi-feature occupies two adjacent nodes, and Yuan (2020) argues that dependent case in Yimas involves clitic dissimilation.

There are two options for how the structure in (76) will surface. One option is that the uninterpretable feature $[uINFL:PERF]$ remains intact and the structure is spelled out with the participial form of *have* (77).

(77) *PF option 1: Participial have*



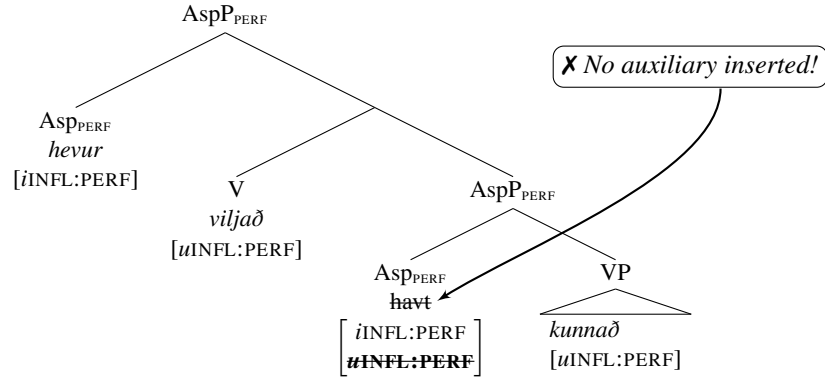
The other option is that the marked combination $[uINFL:PERF]$ and $[iINFL:PERF]$, on Asp_{PERF} triggers impoverishment of the uninterpretable feature and in doing so prevents the insertion of *have* (78).³¹

(78) *Perfect Impoverishment rule*

$[uINFL:PERF] \rightarrow \emptyset / [X^o iINFL:PERF _]$

When the deletion rule in (78) applies, the most deeply embedded verb nevertheless agrees with the interpretable perfect feature and so *have*-omission gives rise to apparent Parasitic Participles (79).

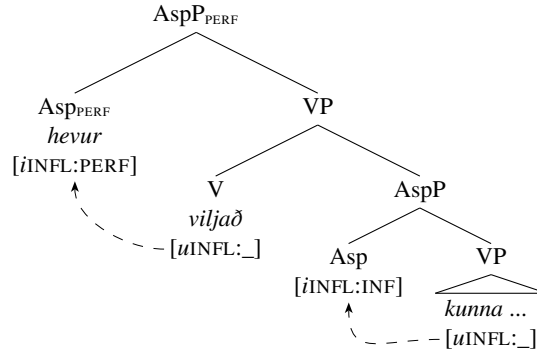
(79) *PF option 2: Impoverishment and no auxiliary insertion*



We do not need to assume anything special for corresponding infinitival clauses. The presence of the interpretable feature $[iINFL:INF]$ means that the embedded verb can only realize an infinitive, regardless of what happens in the higher clause. Each verb agrees with the closest c-commanding head. The highest verb agrees with Asp_{PERF} while the most deeply embedded verb agrees with $[iINFL:INF]$ (80).

³¹Recall that infinitival *have* in Faroese cannot occur in-between two participles. In my account, infinitival *have* always reflects failed agreement when the auxiliary is spelled out before receiving a value. However, if *have* can agree with a c-commanding participle it will always surface as a participle, never as an infinitive.

(80)



The infinitive intervention effect in Faroese is derived in a similar way as in Norwegian and Swedish. This kind of Agree-chain is banned because the $[i\text{INFL:INF}]$ -feature in the structure is a more local goal than *have* (81).

- (81) $[\text{AspP}_{\text{PERF}} \text{ } i\text{INFL:PERF} \dots [\text{VP } V \text{ } u\text{INFL:}_- [\text{AspP } i\text{INFL:INF} [\text{VP } V \text{ } u\text{INFL:}_-]]]]$
- X

Similarly, an infinitival perfect cannot trigger the impoverishment rule in (78) since it lacks $[u\text{INFL:PERF}]$.

Under this kind of view, the intricate combination of independent differences with *have* and the availability of *have*-omission give rise to the same surface order having a different interpretive effect because there is an underlyingly distinct structure.

4.6 Complement size variation in Faroese

The proposal thus far assumes that Faroese does not have genuine restructuring. However, there is in fact some variation in the language. For some Faroese verbs, like *lata* ‘let’, which do allow Parasitic Participles, it is surprisingly difficult to detect an interpretive effect (82a), and uniquely for such verbs, an overt *have*-auxiliary cannot occur in the embedded clause (82b). In fact, an overt *have*-auxiliary cannot occur in the corresponding sentence in English either (83).

- (82) a. Barnagentan hevði **latið** hana {*fáa* / **fingið**} turriklæð-ið.
 nanny.the had.PST let.PTCP her.ACC get.INF / get.PTCP towel-the.
 b. *Barnagentan hevði **latið** hana {**havt** / *hava*} **fingið** turriklæð-ið.
 nanny.the had.PST let.PTCP her.ACC have.PTCP / have.INF get.PTCP towel-the.
 ‘The nanny had let her have the towel.’

- (83) *The nanny had let her **have** had / got the towel.

(82) indicates that some predicates in Faroese might actually select for a bare VP Event complement as in Norwegian and Swedish, and not a Situation complement with an Asp-head.³² The availability of true Parasitic Participles in Faroese with some verbs, as well as the existence of true Parasitic Participles in other Scandinavian languages, might explain the variation in how these sentences are interpreted in the literature (see Lockwood 1977, Sandøy 1991, Henriksen 2000, Thráinsson et al. 2012). For instance, Thráinsson et al. (2012) claim that past tense modals with a participial complement can be interpreted either as an infinitive or as a perfect in examples like (84).

- (84) a. Hon kundi *fara*, hvar hon vildi.
 he could.PST go.INF where she wanted.PST
 ‘She could go where she wanted to.’

³²In the next section, we will see that Norwegian and Swedish Parasitic Participles also behave differently from the Faroese kind in terms of VP Fronting. If Faroese verbs like *lata* ‘let’ also take Event complements, we might expect that it would show the same behavior as Norwegian and Swedish. Unfortunately, this cannot be tested as none of the relevant verbs, including *lata*, allow VP Fronting.

- b. Hon kundi **farið**, um hon vildi.
 he could.PST go.PTCP if she wanted.PST
 ‘She could go / have gone if she wanted to.’ (Faroeese; Thráinsson et al. 2012: 75–77).

One possible explanation is that some speakers might allow restructuring parasitic morphology with past tense modals. However, I did not find this variation among my consultants. They invariably preferred the perfect interpretation in examples like (84b) given a clear experiential context. Infinitival complements, however, were interpreted with a non-perfect reading. In (85), a past participle is necessary for a felicitous reading.

Context: Your mother regrets not having gone to Woodstock in 1969. Your dad is not sympathetic and says:

- (85) a. Hon kundi (havt) **farið**, um hon vildi.
 she could.PST have.PTCP gone.PTCP if she wanted.PST
 ‘She could have gone if she wanted to.’
 b. #Hon kundi *fara*, um hon vildi.
 she could.PST go.INF if she wanted.PST
 ‘She could have gone if she wanted to.’ (Faroeese)

When the context requires a non-perfect interpretation, as in (86), the past participle cannot be used and only the infinitival is felicitous.

Context: Your sister’s friends want her to go to a party later tonight. You ask your mother whether your sister can also go the party and your mother replies:

- (86) a. #Hon kundi **farið**, um hon vildi.
 she could.PST go if she wanted.PST
 ‘She could have gone if she wanted to.’
 b. Hon kundi *fara* um hon vildi.
 she can.PST go if she wanted.PST
 ‘She could go if she wanted to.’ (Faroeese)
Consultant comment: The party hasn’t happened yet so kundi farið doesn’t work.

Accordingly, the cases in which non-perfect interpretations are reported for these verbs in Faroeese might involve different grammars. Some speakers may have genuine Parasitic Participles with Event complements, like Norwegian and Swedish speakers, rather than Situation complements with no Inf-layer.³³

The preceding analysis accounts for Faroeese Parasitic Participles under the assumption that they involve a Situation complement and a silent *have*. However, Faroeese also allows Parasitic Participles in Event complements, for instance, with modals like *vilja* ‘want’. Setting aside the previously noted variation in (84), Faroeese Event complements are nevertheless different from Norwegian and Swedish Event complements since the former also allow an experiential reading as in (87).

Context: The speaker is expressing regret over never having met their grandmother who has died.

- (87) Eg havi altíð **viljað** **møtt** / # *møta* ommu mínari.
 I have.PRS always wanted.PTCP meet.PTCP / meet.INF grandmother.DAT my.DAT
 ‘I have always wanted to have met my grandmother’ (Faroeese)

I take examples like (87) to indicate that restructuring is not obligatory in all languages. One concrete approach to this intuition comes from Wurmbrand and Lohninger (2023) who argue that non-proposition complements can in principle project a full structure but, in these cases, the higher layers are semantically vacuous. Following such work, I assume that tenseless complements in Faroeese are the same as tensed complements, except that

³³ *Have*-omission in past tense complements is not straightforwardly compatible with the impoverishment rule in (78). For these complements, embedded *have* is not c-commanded by a higher *have* and so it should not be valued as [_uINFL:PERF]. Two possibilities suggest themselves. Either the past tense modals in Faroeese inherently possess a purely morphological PERF-feature (like Embick’s 2000 deponent PASS-feature) or there is an additional source for a counterfactual feature (Iatridou 2000, Bjorkman and Halpert 2017). I leave the precise explanation of *have*-omission with past tense modals to future research.

the higher layers of the structure are semantically vacuous. Situation complements are the minimum size for non-finite aspectuals in Faroese and so true Parasitic Participles are impossible with aspectual verbs.

In conclusion, the same underlying mechanism can account for Faroese, and Norwegian and Swedish. The difference lies in what head licenses the participles. In Faroese, this is not the matrix perfect, but an embedded, silent *have* auxiliary. I modeled the silent *have* with a markedness-driven impoverishment rule which deletes the inflectional feature triggering the perfect auxiliary. In the next section, I argue that this analysis finds independent support in the different profiles of VP Fronting in Faroese, and Norwegian and Swedish.

5 VP Fronting repair

This section provides an argument for the account of Parasitic Participles developed here from a difference in how parasitic morphology in Faroese interacts with VP fronting compared to Norwegian and Swedish. Crucially, Parasitic Participles cannot be c-commanded by an infinitive. However, this effect is circumvented in Norwegian and Swedish when the Participle VP moves to a position where it c-commands the infinitive.

- (88) a. [**Pratet** italiensk]_α hadde han alltid villet **ønsket** / *ønske* _{−α}.
[speak.PTCP Italian] have.PST he always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP / can.INF
b. [**Prate** italiensk]_α hadde han alltid villet **ønsket** / *ønske* _{−α}.
[speak.INF Italian] have.PST he always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP / can.INF
‘As for speaking Italian, he has always wanted to be able to.’ (Norwegian)

I argue that this pattern follows from the Agree analysis of verbal morphology under the assumption that the VP moves to spec, *vP* on its way to spec, CP and that the probe can agree again from its new position, this time with PERF. I propose that this is possible due to probes remaining active after Agree until they are linked to a valued interpretable feature. Importantly, however, Faroese does not allow this repair.³⁴

- (89) a. [**Skilt** italskt]_α hevur hann altíð viljað **kunnað** / **kunna* _{−α}.
[understand.PTCP Italian] have.PRS he always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP / can.INF
‘As for having understood Italian, he has always wanted to have been able to.’
b. [**Skilja** italskt]_α hevur hann altíð viljað **kunnað** / *kunna* _{−α}.
[understand.INF Italian] have.PRS he always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP / can.INF
‘As for understanding Italian, he has always wanted to have been able to.’ (Faroese)

I argue that the Faroese structure can be understood in light of its clause size which guarantees that the probe will always agree with an interpretable feature from its base position and be deactivated there.

5.1 VP Fronting in Scandinavian

This section shows that VP Fronting in Scandinavian involves syntactic movement based on sensitivity to islands and reconstructions effects. First, note that like English VP Fronting, the Scandinavian languages allow stranding of a modal or a perfect auxiliary while other stranded elements require an additional dummy auxiliary ‘do’ (which is also optionally available with modals and the perfect auxiliary). The fronted VP normally shows connectivity effects and retains the morphology of its base position. For example, if the perfect auxiliary selects a participial complement, the complement retains its participial morphology when it is fronted (90).³⁵

- (90) a. [Lisið bók-ina], havi eg (**gjørt**).
read.PTCP book-the have.PRS I done.PTCP
‘As for reading the book, I have done.’ (Faroese)
b. [lest bok-en] har han (**gjørt**) på ferie.
read.PTCP bok-the has.PRS he (do.PTCP) on holidays

³⁴As in (29), I use the verb *skilja* ‘understand’ in Faroese to ensure that the participle has a distinct pronunciation from the infinitive.

³⁵Hein (2018) claims that in Norwegian, the dummy verb is obligatory when an auxiliary is stranded. However, my consultants can omit the dummy verb with *ha* ‘have’, I will assume it is optional.

- ‘As for reading the book, he has done so on holidays.’ (Norwegian; Hein 2018: 283)
- c. [Läst böcker] har han nästan aldrig (**gjort**).
 read.PTCP books has.PRS he almost never (done.PTCP)
 ‘As for reading books, he almost never has done.’ (Swedish)

I will assume here that VP Fronting is movement across the three languages (for other movement accounts of VP Fronting see e.g., Landau 2006 and Vicente 2007). Evidence for a movement analysis comes from island and reconstruction effects. VP Fronting in these languages is possible out of non-island contexts, but not e.g., Complex NP islands ($_{\alpha}$ marks the moved element and its trace). This is shown for Faroese (91), Norwegian (92) and Swedish (93).

- (91) a. [**Lisið bók-ina**] $_{\alpha}$, noktaði hon at hon hevði kunnað nádd $_{-\alpha}$.
 read.PTCP book-the, refused.PST she that she had.PST can.PTCP manage.PTCP
 ‘As for having read the book, she refused that she could have managed.’
 b. *[[**Lisið bók-ina**] $_{\alpha}$, noktaði hon, [tað uppáhald-ið at hon hevði kunnað
 read.PTCP book-the, refused.PST she the claim-the that she had.PST can.PTCP
 nádd $_{-\alpha}$].
 manage.PTCP
 ‘As for having read the book, she refused the claim that she could have managed.’ (Faroese)
- (92) a. [**Å vaske bil-en**] $_{\alpha}$ tror jeg ikke at hun vil at han gjør $_{-\alpha}$ idag.
 to wash.INF car-the believe.PRS I not that she wants.PRS that he does.PRS today.
 ‘As for washing the car, I don’t think that she wants him to do today.’
 b. *[[**Å vaske bil-en**] $_{\alpha}$ hørte jeg [rykte om at han gjør $_{-\alpha}$ i dag].
 to wash.INF car-the heard.PST I rumour about that he do.PRS today
 ‘As for washing the car, I heard a rumour that he did today.’ (Norwegian; Hein 2018: 283)
- (93) a. [**Läste bok-en**] $_{\alpha}$ sa John att han gjorde $_{-\alpha}$.
 read.PST book-the say.PST John that he did.PST
 ‘As for reading the book, John said that he did that.’
 b. *[[**Läste bok-en**] $_{\alpha}$ tillbakavisade John [påståend-et att han gjorde $_{-\alpha}$].
 read.PST book-the refused.PST John claim-the that he did.PST
 ‘As for reading the book, John refused the claim that he did.’ (Swedish; Platzack 2012: 280)

We also find reconstruction effects in Scandinavian VP Fronting, that is, instances where a fronted constituent is interpreted as if it were in its base generated position. This is shown with Condition C effects below. None of these languages allow an R-expression in the initial constituent to be co-referential with an anaphor which it c-commands. However, if the anaphor appears in the initial constituent and it c-commands the co-referring R-expression, the sentence is grammatical. This is shown for Faroese (94), Norwegian (95) and Swedish (96).

- (94) a. *[(**at**) **hugt at eini mynd av Jógvani**] $_{i}$ hevði hann $_{i}$ næstan ongantíð kunnað $_{-\alpha}$.
 to look.PTCP to a photo of Jógvan have.PST he almost never can.PTCP
 ‘As for having looked at a photo of Jógvan, he almost never could have.’
 b. [(**at**) **hugt at eini mynd av sjálvum sær**] $_{i}$ hevði Jógvan $_{i}$ næstan ongantíð kunnað
 to look.PTCP to a photo of himself have.PST Jógvan almost never can.PTCP
 $_{-\alpha}$.
 ‘As for having looked at a photo of himself, Jógvan almost never could have.’ (Faroese)
- (95) a. *[(**å**) **se på et bilde av Helge**] $_{i}$ gjør han $_{i}$ nesten aldri $_{-\alpha}$.
 to look.INF at a photo of Helge does.PRS he almost never
 ‘As for looking at a photo of Helge, he almost never does.’
 b. [(**å**) **hate seg selv**] $_{i}$ gjør han $_{i}$ $_{-\alpha}$ bare når han er full.
 to hate.INF himself does.PRS he only when he is drunk
 ‘As for hating himself, he only when he is drunk.’ (Norwegian; Hein 2018: 285)

- (96) a. ***[Läst böcker av John_i]_α** har han_i nästan aldrig gjort _{−α}.
 read.PTCP books by John has.PRS he almost never done.PTCP
 ‘As for reading books by John, he has almost never done.’
 b. **[Tvivlat på sig själv]_i**_α har John tyvärr alltid gjort _{−α}.
 doubt.PTCP on himself has.PRS John unfortunately always done.PTCP
 ‘As for doubting himself, John has unfortunately always done.’ (Swedish)

Since Scandinavian VP Fronting shows the expected movement behavior for both island sensitivity and reconstruction effects for binding, I will assume that it is movement.

5.2 Parasitic morphology in intermediate position in Norwegian and Swedish

In this section, we will see that fronting a VP in a Parasitic Participle configuration has a surprising morphological effect. Recall that in Faroese, Norwegian and Swedish, infinitives act as interveners for parasitic agreement. Each Parasitic Participle is conditioned by the closest preceding participle, and an infinitive gives rise to an intervention effect (97).

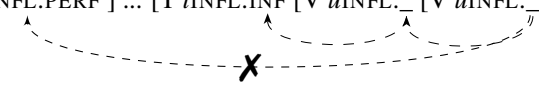
- (97) a. Han har alltid **villet ønsket** / ***ønske pratet** italienskt.
 he have.PRS always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP / can.INF speak.PTCP Italian
 ‘He has always wanted to be able to speak Italian.’ (Norwegian)
 b. Han har alltid **velat kunnat** / ***kunna pratat** italienska.
 he have.PRS always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP / can.INF speak.PTCP Italian
 ‘He has always wanted to be able to speak Italian.’ (Swedish)

However, VP Fronting can circumvent the locality condition on parasitic morphology, an effect which I will call *VP Fronting Repair*. Both Norwegian and Swedish allow the lexical VP in an infinitival clause to be fronted. Strikingly, while an infinitive cannot intervene between the higher participle and the parasitic participle in its base generated position, fronting the lexical VP seemingly repairs this pattern, see (98)–(99).

- (98) a. **[Pratet italiensk]_α** hadde han alltid villet ønske _{−α}.
 [speak.PTCP Italian] have.PST he always wanted.PTCP can.INF
 b. **[Prate italiensk]_α** hadde han alltid villet ønske _{−α}.
 [speak.INF Italian] have.PST he always wanted.PTCP can.INF
 ‘As for speaking Italian, he has always wanted to be able to.’ (Norwegian)
 (99) a. **[Pratat italienska]_α** hade han alltid velat kunna _{−α}.
 [speak.PTCP Italian] have.PST he always wanted.PTCP can.INF
 b. **[Prata italienska]_α** hade han alltid velat kunna _{−α}.
 [speak.INF Italian] have.PST he always wanted.PTCP can.INF
 ‘As for speaking Italian, he has always wanted to be able to.’ (Swedish)

Thus, once the the lexical VP is no longer c-commanded by the infinitive, but rather by the higher participle, parasitic agreement is once again grammatical in both languages.

Recall that Wurmbrand’s (2012) syntactic agreement approach accounts for the infinitive intervention by appealing to locality. In infinitival sentences like (97), an Inf-value is always a closer goal for the more deeply embedded verbs than the perfect, and so locality derives the infinitive intervention effect (100).

- (100) [Asp_{PERF} iINFL:PERF] ... [T iINFL:INF [V uINFL: _− [V uINFL: _−]]]]]


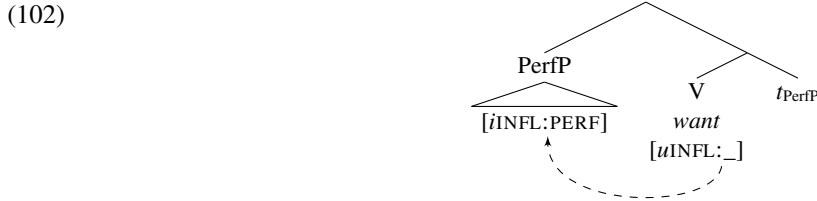
The pattern in (98)–(99) suggests that a new agreement relationship can be established via VP Fronting.

Interestingly, Wurmbrand (2012, 2014a) also argues that movement of the verb should be able to feed its morphological identity in a Reverse Agree analysis of morphological selection. She provides evidence from Parasitic Participles in head-final languages like Frisian where, surprisingly, a participle appears to be licensed

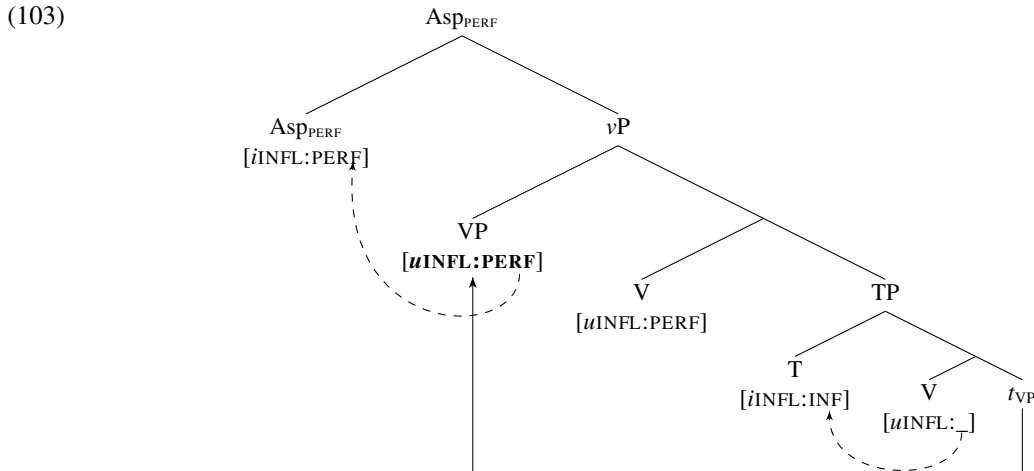
upwards. In (101), the more deeply embedded perfect auxiliary *ha* ‘have’ can condition participial morphology on the embedding modal verb *wolle* ‘want’. This relationship is not surface apparent due to the head-final word order so instead the underlying structure prior to linearization is shown in (101b).

- (101) a. *hy soe it dien ha wolle / wollen.*
 he would it do.PTCP ha.INF want.INF / want.PTCP
 ‘He would like to have it done.’ (Frisian; den Dikken and Hoekstra 1997)
- b. [₁ would.FIN [₂ want.INF/PTCP [₃ have.INF [₄ do.PTCP]]]] (Wurmbrand 2014a)

Wurmbrand (2012, 2014a) argues that in the head-final order, the projection headed by the perfect auxiliary is base-generated below the modal *want* but subsequently re-merged above it before the finite modal *soe* ‘would’ is merged. From its new position, the perfect auxiliary c-commands *want* and accordingly values it (102).



The same intuition underlies my analysis of Scandinavian VP Fronting Repair. I propose that morphological identity can be determined after (certain kinds of) movement. I assume that in VP Fronting, the VP lands in an intermediate position in spec,vP, immediately below the perfect, before its final landing site in spec,CP (following Chomsky 2001 et seq.).³⁶ It is this intermediate landing site that creates the context for VP Fronting Repair in Norwegian and Swedish since the movement bypasses the intervening head with an Inf-value. From here, the VP can agree with the now closer Perf-head and realize a participle (103). My assumptions about phases and the PIC (cf. Section 4.3) ensure that the intermediate Asp and v are in the same Spell-Out domain.



Notice that VP Fronting Repair in fact follows from the Wurmbrand (2012) Agree account of Parasitic Participles. By adopting an intermediate movement step, we generate the prediction that VP Fronting should allow the VP to establish a new agreement relationship which is not possible from its in situ position: A prediction that is empirically borne out in Norwegian and Swedish.

³⁶I do not assume a landing site for the fronted VP below TP. If the VP were to land there, we would expect that it would be deactivated before reaching the higher vP and would never agree with the perfect. Alternatively, we could assume the landing site and that for whatever reason the fronted VP cannot agree with T, perhaps since it has already been linked to it via the intermediate VP.

5.3 Why can the probe agree again?

Our account of VP Fronting Repair provides novel evidence for intermediate movement. However, as it stands, it does not explain precisely why the probe can agree again from its intermediate position if it has already probed upward previously. In this section, I will argue that the new agreement relationship is made possible because the previous agreement is between two [*u*INFL]-features. Probes that agree with an uninterpretable feature can continue to agree until they agree with an interpretable feature. The probe thus remains active following parasitic agreement. In the next section, we will see that Faroese does not allow VP Fronting repair, a fact that I argue comes down to the relevant probes only ever agreeing with interpretable features in Faroese.

Following Chomsky (2000, 2001), much research on syntactic agreement assumes that Agree is subject to an *Activity Condition*. Namely, all uninterpretable features have an unchecked feature which must be deactivated via agreement for the derivation to converge. However, uninterpretable features do not always appear to be deactivated after agreement. Carstens (2011) argues that in Bantu languages like Swahili, an uninterpretable gender feature can act as an Agree goal for multiple verbs as reflected by multiple instances of the prefix *a-* (1SA; 1P-subject agreement) in Swahili (104).

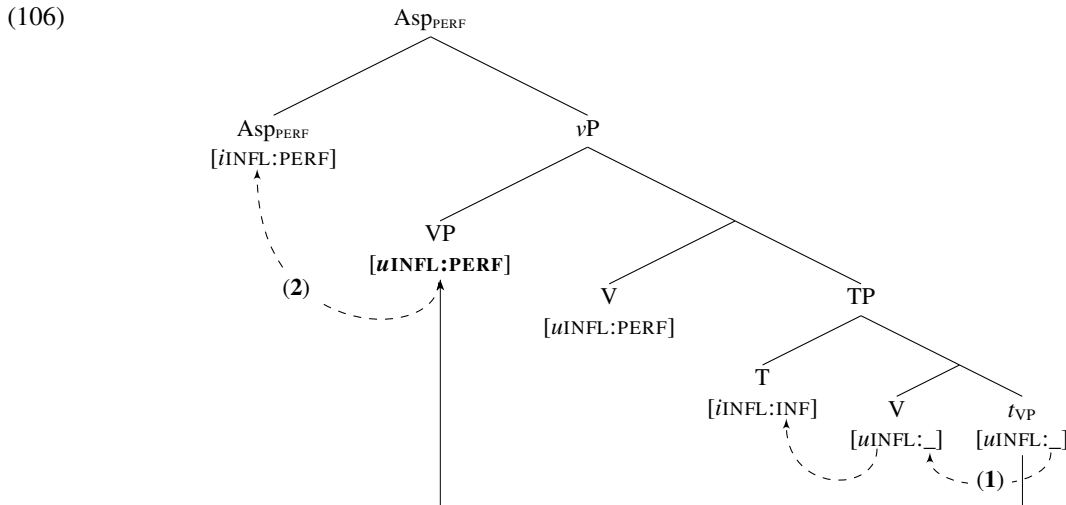
- (104) Juma *a*-li-kuwa *a*-me-pika cahkula.
 Juma 1SA-PST-be 1SA-PERF-cook 7food.
 ‘Jum had cooked food.’ (Swahili; Carstens 2011: 722)

Carstens (2011) argues that this explains why there can be multiple exponents of gender in Bantu. Namely, uninterpretable gender in Bantu is exempt from the Activity Condition. Carstens assumes that goals only become inactive when they acquire a value. She argues that gender in Bantu is inherently valued and so it is not valued via Agree. As a result, gender in Bantu is an infinitely reusable agreement feature which can spread to multiple predicates.

Following a similar logic, I relate the VP Fronting Repair in Norwegian and Swedish to an unvalued probe on the fronted VP which is not made inactive. I propose that if an uninterpretable feature agrees with another uninterpretable feature, as in Parasitic Participle configurations, it remains active until it agrees with an interpretable feature (105).

- (105) **Probe Activity Principle**
 A probe *u*INFL remains active after Agree iff it is not linked to a valued *i*INFL

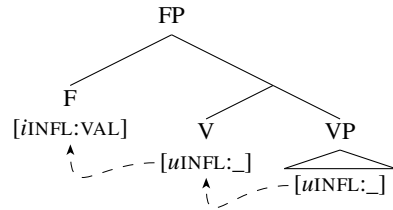
I argue that if a VP establishes agreement with an uninterpretable feature (**1** in (106)), it can match the feature, but it is not deactivated by it (similar to Carstens 2011). Instead, the probe is sensitive to new agreement relations (**2** in (106)) if it becomes local to a new goal later in the derivation, as in VP Fronting (106). Recall that the combination of the Weak PIC and dynamic phasehood places Asp and *v* in the same Spell-Out domain.



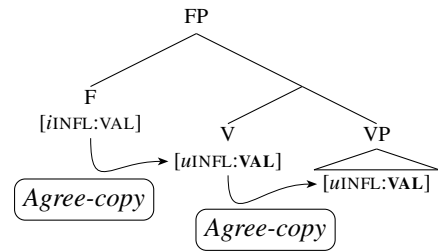
However, without additional assumptions, we predict that if the probe remains active it should copy contradictory features, [*uINFL:INF*] first and then [*uINFL:PERF*]. One way of addressing this problem is to assume that Agree is split into the syntactic *Agree-Link* and the post-syntactic *Agree-Copy* (adopting the terminology in Arregi and Nevins 2012; see also Bhatt and Walkow 2013, Atlamaz and Baker 2018 among others). In such approaches, Agree-link establishes a link between the probe and the goal in the Syntax, and then at PF, Agree-Copy copies the feature values of the goal onto the probe (107)–(108). I implement the two Agree operations in Reverse Agree in accordance with my analysis of Parasitic Participles (107)–(108).

- | | |
|---|---|
| <p>(107) AGREE-LINK
A probe establishes an Agree relation in the syntax based on hierarchy and locality.</p> | <p>AGREE-COPY
The actual feature values of the goal are copied onto the probe.
(cf. Arregi and Nevins 2012: 8)</p> |
|---|---|

- (108) a. *Agree-Link establishes Agree-relation*



- b. *Agree-Copy copies values*



In this model of Agree, Agree-Link crucially precedes Agree-Copy in the derivation. Thus, certain operations are allowed to intervene between the two types of Agree and alter the outcome of Agree-Copy. Arregi and Nevins (2012) argue that we do indeed see this type of Agree intervention in certain dialects of Basque. Typically, the Basque auxiliary only shows agreement with Absolutive arguments. However, in Lekeitio Basque, the auxiliary also shows agreement with a Dative clitic as indicated by the morpheme *-aitu* which reflects agreement with the Dative plural *gu-ri* in (109).

- (109) Mokixe-k gu-ri_i tabaku-a erregala-Ø g_i **-aitu** -Ø
Mokixe-ERG us-DAT_i tobacco-ABS.SG give-PRF CL.A1.PL_i -PRS.1.PL -CL.E.3.SG
‘Mokixe has given us tobacco’ (Lekeitio Basque; Arregi and Nevins 2012: 157)

According to Arregi and Nevins (2012: 157), all Basque dialects establish an Agree-Link with Absolutive and Dative arguments. However, Agree-Copy may only copy feature values from an Absolutive goal and so only Absolutive agreement is realized. Arregi and Nevins (2012) argue that the Dative Agreement in Lekeitio Basque surfaces when an impoverishment rule reduces the featural structure of the Dative to the Absolutive.

I instead propose that agreement with uninterpretable features can be overwritten by agreement with an interpretable feature, so Agree-Copy realizes the final outcome of Agree-Link. A lexical VP embedded within an infinitival clause must agree with the restructuring VP to parasitically receive its infinitive-value (110).

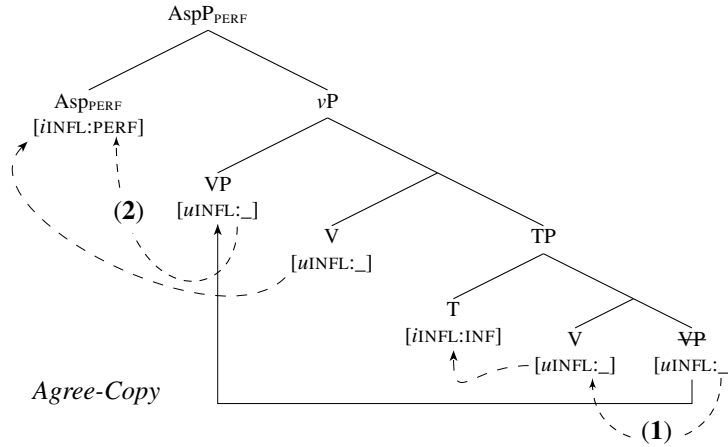
- (110)
-

However, VP Fronting creates a new context for agreement. Once the lexical VP has moved to its intermediate position in spec, *vP* below *AspP_{PERF}*, it can agree a second time (111a). Following a second agreement relationship, this time with Perf, Agree-Copy may realize either of the two matching relations that have been established: the uninterpretable infinitive feature (marked **1** in (111a)) or the interpretable perfect feature (marked **2** in (111a)). If the latter, the fronted verb is realized as a participle, as schematized in (111b).³⁷

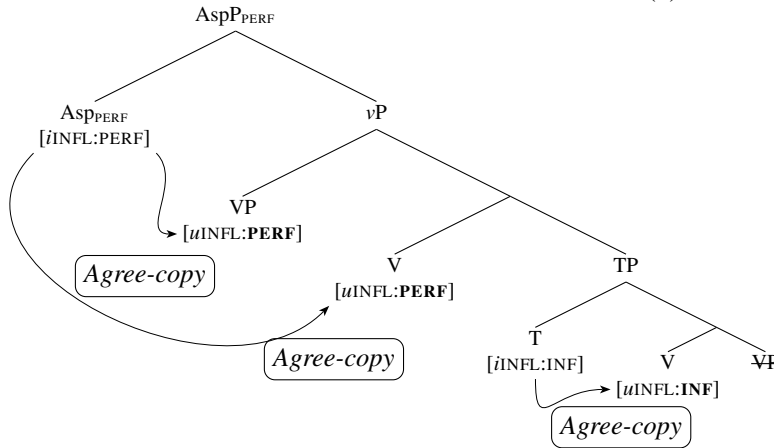
³⁷The PIC is not a problem for this derivation since the weakened version that I am assuming (see (62)) assumes that *v* and *Asp* are

(111) Norwegian and Swedish feature deactivated in spec,vP

a. Agree-Link



b. Agree-Copy



This account is supported in an interesting way with *do*-support. Recall that in both Norwegian and Swedish, *do*-support is optionally available (as indicated by parentheses) in VP Fronting cases if the stranded verb is a modal or the perfect auxiliary (112).

- (112) a. [Å lese bok-en] vil han (gjøre) i dag.
to read.INF bok-the wants.PRS he (do.INF) today
'As for reading the book, he wants to do today.' (Norwegian; Hein 2018: 283)
- b. [Läst böcker] har han nästan aldrig (gjort).
read.PTCP books has.PRS he almost never (done.PTCP)
'As for reading books, he almost never has done.' (Swedish)

In Parasitic Participle contexts, Norwegian *gjera* and Swedish *göra* 'do' effectively behave like other verbs in that they can either agree with the Inf-feature on T, and realize an infinitive, or parasitically agree with the closest participle and appear in a participial form (113).

- (113) a. [Å hjelpt seg]_α hadde da vore fint å hatt noken té å {gjera / gjort _α}.
[Å help.PTCP self] have.PST it be.PTCP good Å have.PTCP someone to Å do.INF / .PTCP
'As for helping him, it would have been good to have someone to do.' (Norwegian)
- b. [Pratat italienska]_α hade han alltid velat kunnat {göra / gjort _α}.
[speak.PTCP Italian] have.PRS he always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP do.INF / .PTCP

in the same Spell-Out domain. Note also that I ignore subsequent movement of the VP to spec, CP in the tree diagrams for the sake of simplicity.

‘As for speaking Italian, he has always wanted to be able to.’

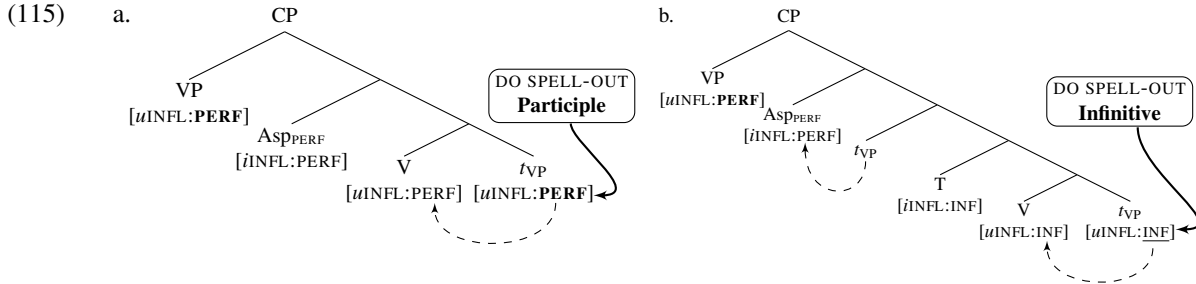
(Swedish)

However, if *do* is locally c-commanded by an infinitive, it must surface as an infinitive, not as a participle (114).

- (114) a. [Å **hjelp** seg]_α hadde da vore fint å ha noken té å {gjera / ***gjort** _α}.
 [Å help.PTCP self] have.PST it be.PTCP good Å have.INF someone to Å do.INF / .PTCP
 ‘As for helping him, it would have been good to have someone to do.’ (Norwegian)
- b. [Pratat italienska]_α hade han alltid **velat** kunna {göra / ***gjort** _α}.
 [speak.PTCP Italian] have.PRS he always wanted.PTCP can.INF do.INF / .PTCP
 ‘As for speaking Italian, he has always wanted to be able to.’ (Swedish)

This fact is evidence that the source of participle agreement cannot be in-situ. Instead, it must be along the movement path. We thus rightly predict optional agreement mismatches between a low *do* and a high participle.

I argue that the two options reflect two different derivations. If the verb embedding *do* is a restructuring verb, it licenses a participle parasitically (115a). Alternatively, the verb is not a restructuring verb and instead licenses an infinitive in-situ while still allowing participial morphology to be licensed on the fronted verb along the path of movement (115b). For the sake of simplicity, I assume that *do* is the Spell-Out of the lower VP and that it is spelled out with the features of the verb (see also Houser et al. 2011 on Danish *gøre* ‘do’). Thus, the lower and higher copies end up being linked to different features which results in different agreement.³⁸



VP Fronting with *do*-support substantiates the claim that parasitic morphology is licensed in an intermediate position. At first sight, it is surprising that the low *do* appears as an infinitive while the VP which moved from its position is a participle in its final landing site. However, the different forms of *do* and the fronted VP can be straightforwardly understood if the participle is licensed not in situ but along the path of movement. Thus, *do*-support provides further evidence for non-situ licensing of the participle in Norwegian and Swedish.

5.4 No VP Fronting repair in Faroese

In this section, we move on to VP Fronting in Faroese. While Norwegian and Swedish allow a second agreement dependency from an intermediate landing site, provided Parasitic Participles can be licensed, Faroese does not. Instead, the fronted verb must always realize the morphology assigned in its base position (117).³⁹

- (116) Hann hevur altíð **viljað** **kunnað** / **kunna* **skilt** italskt.
 he have.PRS always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP / can.INF understand.PTCP Italian
 ‘He has always wanted to be able to understand Italian.’ (Faroese)
- (117) a. [Skilt italskt]_α hevur hann altíð viljað **kunnað** / **kunna* _α.
 [understand.PTCP Italian] have.PRS he always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP / can.INF
 ‘As for having understood Italian, he has always wanted to have been able to.’

³⁸Crucially, this account requires a copy theory of movement (following Chomsky 1995) rather than a multi-dominance theory (see e.g. Citko 2005). The verb phrase cannot be the same object in both positions if the two positions can be related to contradictory features.

³⁹While Scandinavian infinitival clauses allow the fronting of a single VP, Frisian only allows fronting of the entire verb cluster (Eric Hoekstra, p.c.). VP Fronting is not applicable to American English as Parasitic Participles only spread to a single verb (Jim Wood, p.c.).

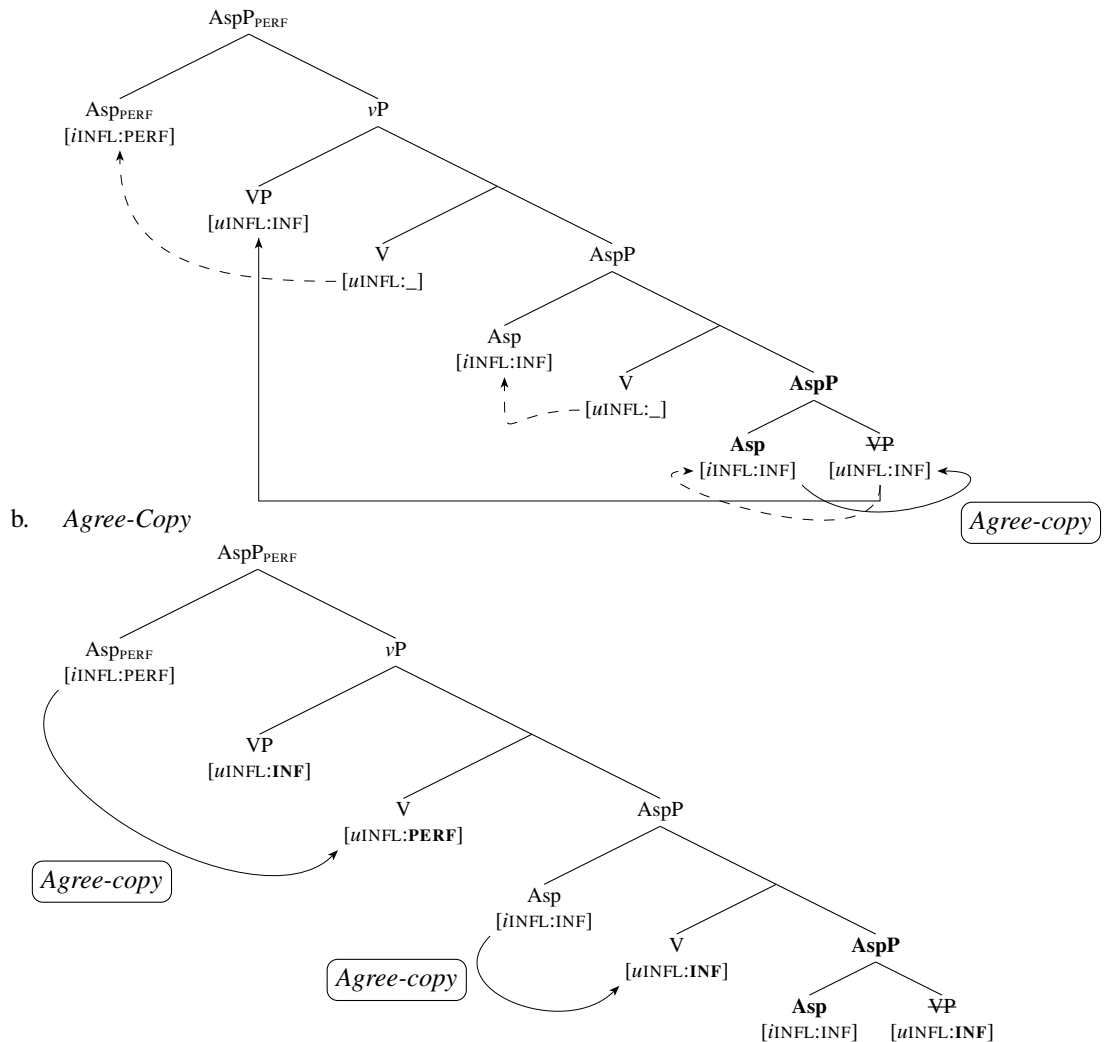
- b. [Skilja italskt]_α hefur hann allíð viljað **kunnað** / *kunna* _{−α}.
[understand.INF Italian] have.PRS he always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP / can.INF
'As for understanding Italian, he has always wanted to have been able to.' (Faroese)

(117) provides evidence that non-finite morphology arises differently in Faroese than in Norwegian and Swedish.

A system in which the lowest copy can only agree again when there is no interpretable feature in the embedded structure allows us to understand why Faroese is different. As Norwegian and Swedish restructuring clauses lack an interpretable feature, the most deeply embedded verb must agree with an uninterpretable feature. However, as there is no true restructuring in Faroese clauses the probe on the most deeply embedded verb always agrees with an interpretable feature and is deactivated in situ. There is no derivation in which verb itself does not agree with an interpretable feature because it is the VP that moves. The verb will either agree with an Inf-value or it will agree with *have*. If the VP is embedded under Asp, it will first agree with [*i*INFL:INF] before it moves to spec,vP (118a). Further agreement from spec,vP, is blocked, forcing Agree-Copy to realize an infinitive (118b).

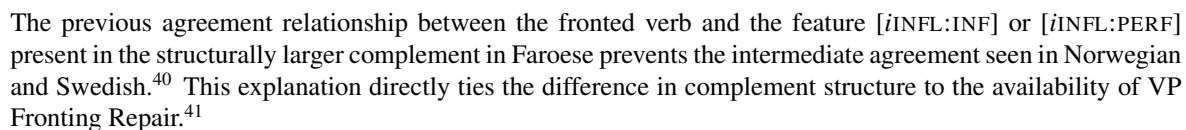
- (118) *Faroese infinitive assigned in VP-base position*

- a. *Agree-Link*



If the VP, on the other hand, is embedded under Perf, it will agree with [*i*INFL:PERF] before it moves to its

(119) *Faroese participle assigned in VP-base position Agree-Link*



(120) a. [*Les* bók-ina], kundi eg (*gera*).
read.INF book-the could.PST I do.INF
'As for reading the book, I could do'
b. [**Li**sið bók-ina], havi eg (**gj**ørt).
read.PTCP book-the have.PRS I done.PTCP
'As for reading the book, I have done.'
(*Faroese*)

(121) a. [Skilt italskt]_α hefur hann alltför viljað kunnað *gera / gjört _{-α}.
[understand.PTCP Italian] have.PRS he always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP do.INF / .PTCP
'As for having understood Italian, he has always wanted to have been able to.'

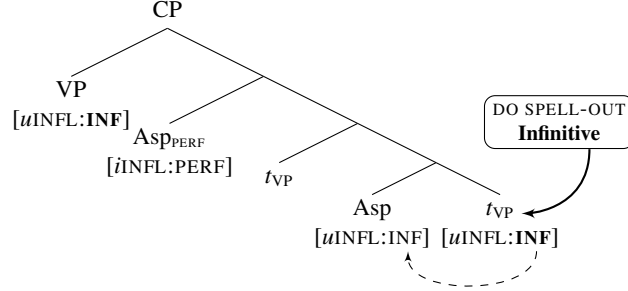
⁴¹In finite VP Fronting, Norwegian and Swedish allow the fronted verb phrase to show up in its tensed form (i).

- In Faroese, the fronted verb in such contexts must be an infinitive. Ultimately, we would want to derive this fact, but I set it aside here.

- b. [Skilja italskt]_α hevur hann altíð **viljað** **kunnað** gera / * **gjørt** _{-α}.
 [understand.INF Italian] have.PRS he always wanted.PTCP can.PTCP do.INF / .PTCP
 ‘As for understanding Italian, he has always wanted to be able to.’ (Faroese)

While it may initially be surprising that Faroese *do*-support does not pattern like Norwegian and Swedish, it follows from our analysis of VP Fronting in Faroese. Namely, the Faroese VP agrees with a valued infinitive feature in its base position and is immediately deactivated. Consequently, the moved VP cannot agree from its intermediate landing site in spec, *v*P and must instead match the features of the base position. As *do* also realizes the features of the base position, the fronted VP and low *do* must match in Faroese (122).

(122)



Our analysis of Faroese VP Fronting accounts for the behavior of Faroese *do*-support without any independent assumptions. By extension, the *do*-support facts also provide independent support for our larger complement size analysis of Faroese Parasitic Participles. Once again, we can understand the unique behavior of Faroese Parasitic Participles in light of their larger complement and necessarily *have*-licensed participles.

6 Conclusion

This paper has argued that Faroese Parasitic Participles offer novel evidence that verbal inflection should be modeled with syntactic agreement, following Wiklund (2007), Bjorkman (2011), Wurmbrand (2012) and others. Parasitic morphology already provides one important argument for inflection-as-agreement since such accounts predict that verbal morphology can be semantically vacuous under the right circumstances. Faroese bears out another prediction, namely, that auxiliaries could be the target of parasitic morphology. What initially appears to be a case of non-parasitic morphology in Faroese is in fact licensed by means of an independent process of *have*-omission. This analysis also finds independent support in VP fronting which further suggests that the correlation between auxiliaries and verbal morphology is best viewed as syntactic agreement.

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